ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 54

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Cherokee Alphabet

ᏣᎳᎩ ᎫᎪᏯᏢ

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say all 85 Signs of the Cherokee Syllabary with English Phonetics

Ꮳ ᏩᏇ

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

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My First Cherokee Alphabet — ᏣᎳᎩ ᎯᎠᏍᏕ
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 54

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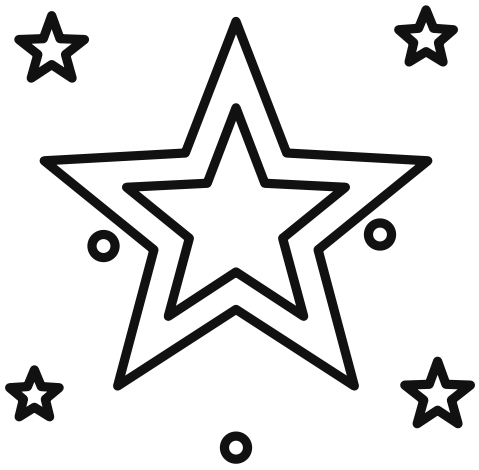
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A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.

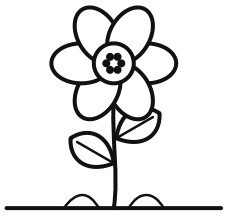


This book belongs to
ᎯᎠ ᎠᏰᎵ ...

I started learning Cherokee on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 54 is Cherokee. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- Cherokee vowels: **a** = 'ah', **e** = 'eh', **i** = 'ee', **o** = 'oh', **u** = 'oo', and **v** = 'uh' through the nose (we write it **uhn**).
- Syllables are joined with hyphens: *ah-dah* means say "ah" then "dah".
- **j** in the guide is the Cherokee *ts* sound (many speakers say it like 'j' in "jam"); **gw** is the *qu* sound.
- Cherokee also uses **pitch** (high and low tones) and long and short vowels, which this simple guide does not show — listen to a speaker!

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Cherokee name** written in Cherokee (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Its row in the syllabary* shows the whole row of Sequoyah's chart that the sign belongs to, with the sign itself in a frame, so children learn the chart a row at a time.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow the Oklahoma (Cherokee Nation) way of speaking.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Cherokee! ᏣᎳᎩ

jah-lah-gee (tsalagi) — the Cherokee word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **2,000 people** speak Cherokee as their first language, and thousands of children and adults are learning it in schools and classes.[3]

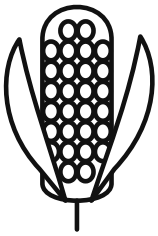
Where?
In the **United States**: mostly in **Oklahoma** and in the mountains of **North Carolina**.

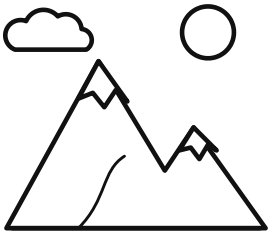
How is it written?
In the **Cherokee syllabary**, from **left to right**. Each sign stands for a whole syllable, like Ꮀ *ga* or Ᏼ *sa*.

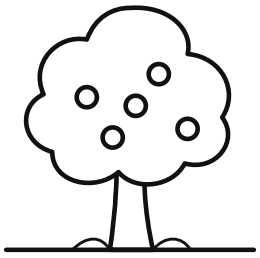
How many signs?
85 signs: 6 vowels and 79 syllables, set out in a chart of rows.

Who made it?
A Cherokee man named **Sequoyah** created the syllabary around **1821**. Within a few years, many Cherokee people could read and write it!

Did you know?
Some signs look like English letters but say other sounds: Ꮃ looks like W but says *la*, and Ꮥ looks like S but says *du*.







THE WHOLE ALPHABET

The Cherokee Alphabet ᏣᎳᎩ ᎯᎠᏍᏓᏁ

6 the vowels — Ꭰ

Ꭰ	Ꭱ	Ꭲ	Ꭳ	Ꭴ	Ꭵ
a	*e*	*i*	*o*	*u*	*v*

19 g, k, h and l — Ꮥ Ꮻ Ꮾ

Ꮥ	Ꮻ	Ꮾ	Ꮿ	ᎀ	ᎁ	ᎂ	ᎃ	ᎄ	ᎅ
ga	*ka*	*ge*	*gi*	*go*	*gu*	*gv*	*ha*	*he*	*hi*
ᎆ	ᎇ	ᎈ	ᎉ	ᎊ	ᎋ	ᎌ	ᎍ	ᎎ	
ho	*hu*	*hv*	*la*	*le*	*li*	*lo*	*lu*	*lv*	

19 m, n and gw — Ᏼ Ᏽ Ᏹ

Ᏼ	Ᏽ	Ᏹ	Ᏺ	Ᏻ	Ᏼ	Ᏽ	Ᏹ	Ᏺ	Ᏻ
ma	*me*	*mi*	*mo*	*mu*	*na*	*hna*	*nah*	*ne*	*ni*
Ᏼ	Ᏽ	Ᏹ	Ᏺ	Ᏻ	Ᏼ	Ᏽ	Ᏹ	Ᏺ	
no	*nu*	*nv*	*qua*	*que*	*qui*	*quo*	*quu*	*quv*	

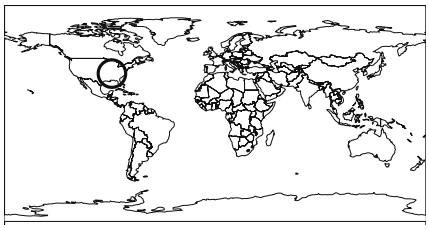
16 s, d and t — Ᏼ Ᏽ

Ᏼ	Ᏽ	Ᏹ	Ᏺ	Ᏻ	Ᏼ	Ᏽ	Ᏹ	Ᏺ	Ᏻ
sa	*s*	*se*	*si*	*so*	*su*	*sv*	*da*	*ta*	*de*
Ᏼ	Ᏽ	Ᏹ	Ᏺ	Ᏻ	Ᏼ				
te	*di*	*ti*	*do*	*du*	*dv*				

25 tl, j, w and y — Ꮼ Ꮽ Ꮾ Ꮿ

Ᏼ	Ᏽ	Ᏹ	Ᏺ	Ᏻ	Ᏼ	Ᏽ	Ᏹ	Ᏺ	Ᏻ
dla	*tla*	*tle*	*tli*	*tlo*	*tlu*	*tlv*	*tsa*	*tse*	*tsi*
Ᏼ	Ᏽ	Ᏹ	Ᏺ	Ᏻ	Ᏼ	Ᏽ	Ᏹ	Ᏺ	Ᏻ
tso	*tsu*	*tsv*	*wa*	*we*	*wi*	*wo*	*wu*	*wv*	*ya*
Ᏼ	Ᏽ	Ᏹ	Ᏺ	Ᏻ					
ye	*yi*	*yo*	*yu*	*yv*					

Read the chart row by row: each row keeps one consonant and runs through a, e, i, o, u, v — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows the south-east of North America.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Cherokee spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the sea **blue**. **Find it:** Cherokee is spoken around **Tahlequah** in Oklahoma and around the town of **Cherokee** in the mountains of North Carolina.

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The Vowels D

a

The Cherokee syllabary begins with **six vowels**. Five are like English vowels; the sixth, **i (v)**, is a humming “uh” sound said through the nose.

Ꭰ	Ꭱ	Ꭲ	Ꭳ	Ꭴ	Ꭵ
a	*e*	*i*	*o*	*u*	*v*

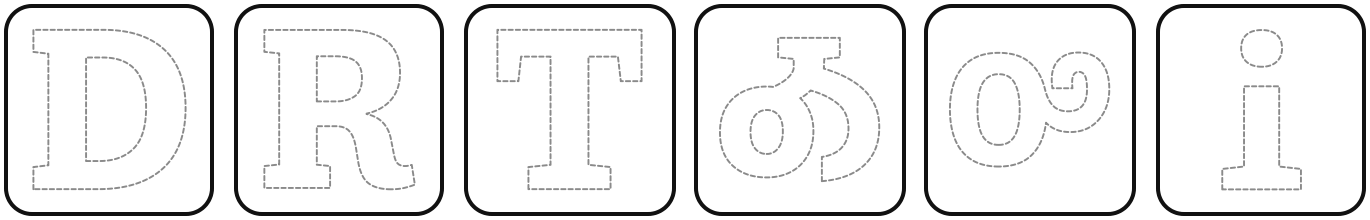
One sign, one syllable
Most signs in the syllabary are a whole syllable: a consonant *and* a vowel together, like **Ꮣ ga** or **Ꮝ sa**. Only six signs are vowels on their own — these six!

They look a bit like English letters…
…but they are not! **Ꭰ** looks like D but says *a*; **Ꭱ** looks like R but says *e*; **Ꭲ** looks like T but says *i*. Say the Cherokee sound, not the English letter.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the vowels D

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



D

NAME · SVi

D

a

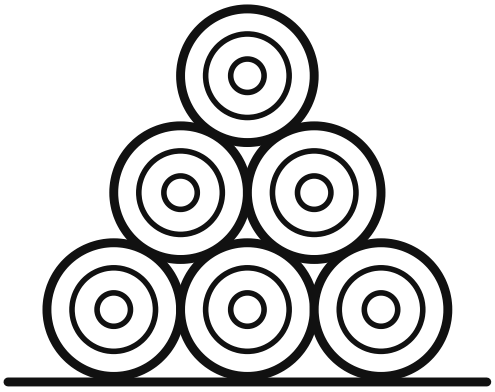
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ah’ as in “father”.

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

D	R	T	ꭰ	Ꮿ	i	
a	e	i	o	u	v	

The box shows this sign in **the vowel row** of the syllabary chart.



D IS FOR

DᏏ

ah-dah

wood, a stick

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · AᏯᏫW

D D D D

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R

NAME · SVi

R

e

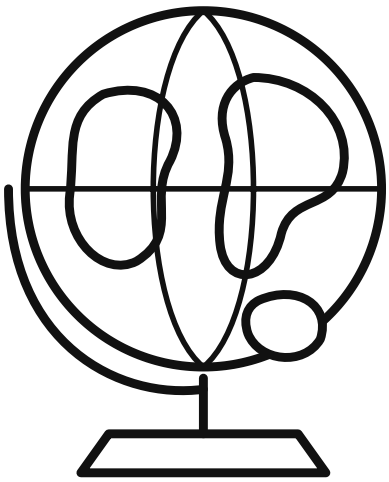
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘eh’ as in “bed”.

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

D	R	T	Ꮷ	Ꮿ	i
a	e	i	o	u	v

The box shows this sign in **the vowel row** of the syllabary chart.



R IS FOR

ᏒᎦᏯ

eh-loh-hee

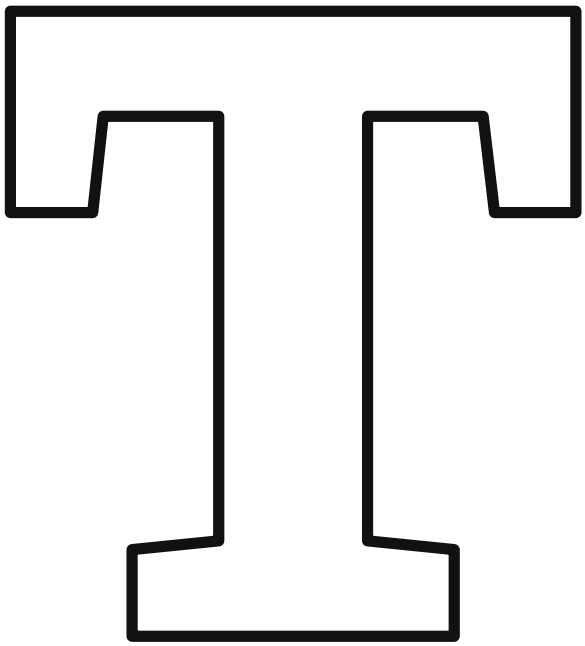
earth, the world

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏰᎳᎳᏔ

R R R R

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NAME · SVi

T

i

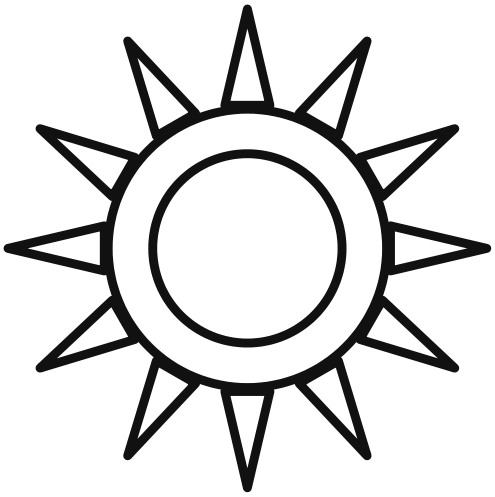
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‘ee’ as in “see”.

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

D	R	T	Ꮴ	Ꮿ	i
a	e	i	o	u	v

The box shows this sign in **the vowel row** of the syllabary chart.



T IS FOR

TS

ee-gah

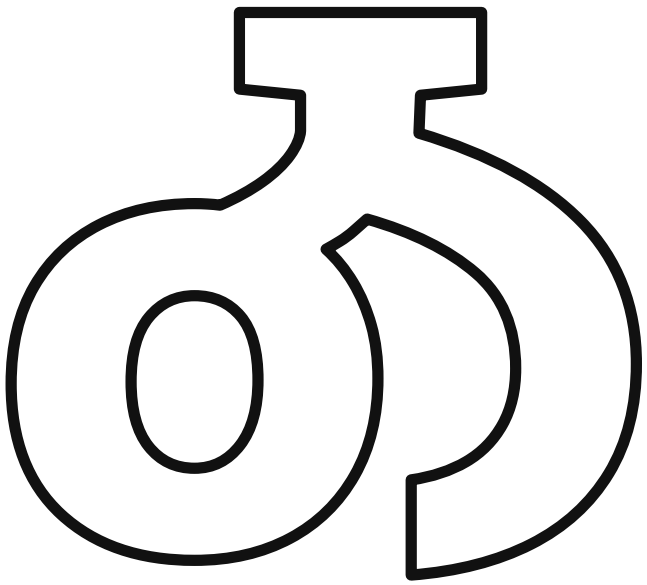
day, daytime

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏁ

T T T T

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NAME · SVi

ꭰ

o

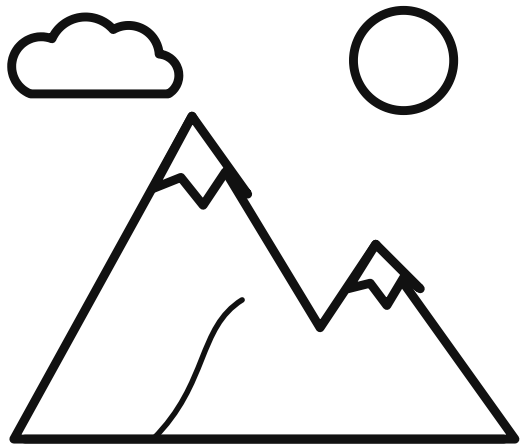
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘oh’ as in “go”.

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

D	R	T	ꭰ	Ꭿ	i
a	e	i	o	u	v

The box shows this sign in **the vowel row** of the syllabary chart.



ꭰ IS FOR

ꭰᏓᏢ

oh-dah-lee

mountain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏍᎩᎳ

ꭰ ꭰ ꭰ ꭰ

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Ꮿ

NAME · SVi

Ꮿ

u

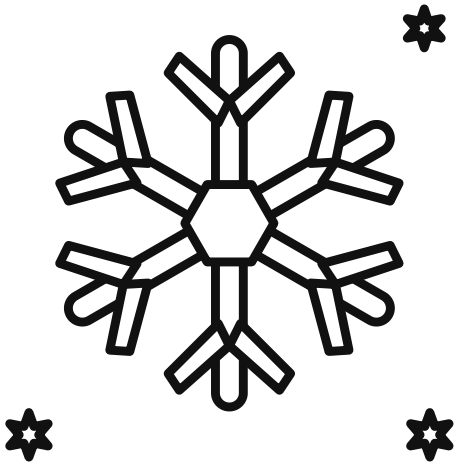
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘oo’ as in “moon”.

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

D	R	T	Ꭴ	Ꮿ	i
a	e	i	o	u	v

The box shows this sign in **the vowel row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꮿ IS FOR

ᏬᏂᎾᏂᏥ

oo-nuhn-jee

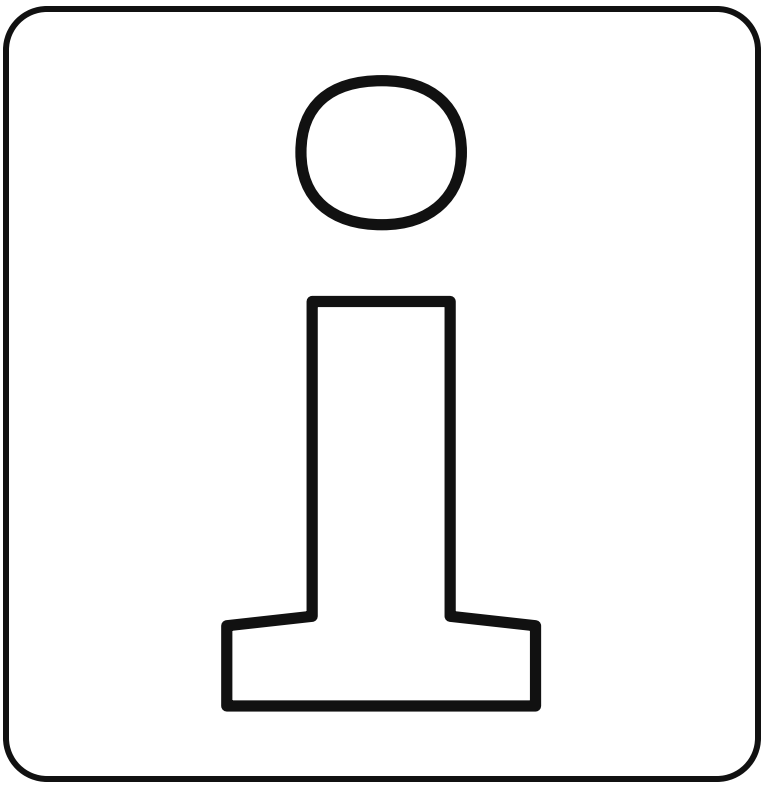
snow

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · AᏯᎱW

Ꮿ Ꮿ Ꮿ Ꮿ

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NAME · SVi

i

v

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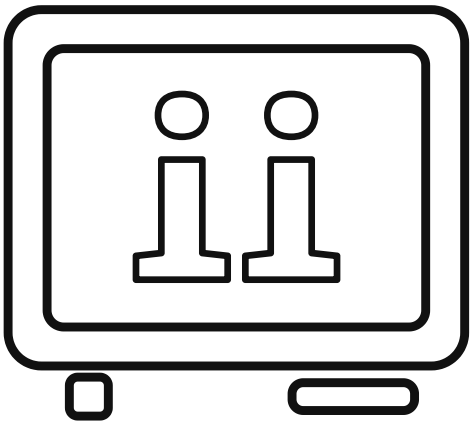
‘uh’ said through the nose, like a humming “uh”.

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

D	R	T	ꮆ	Ꮋ	i
a	e	i	o	u	v

The box shows this sign in **the vowel row** of the syllabary chart.

Very few words start with i. The best known is ii “yes”; iᏝ means “no”.



i IS FOR

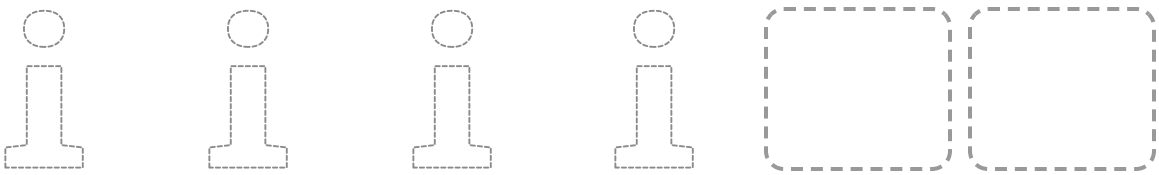
ii

uhn-uhn

yes!

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ



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THE SYLLABARY

G, K, H and L Ꮣ Ꮻ W

ga · ha · la

Now the syllables begin! Each row of the chart keeps one consonant and runs through the vowels **a e i o u v**.

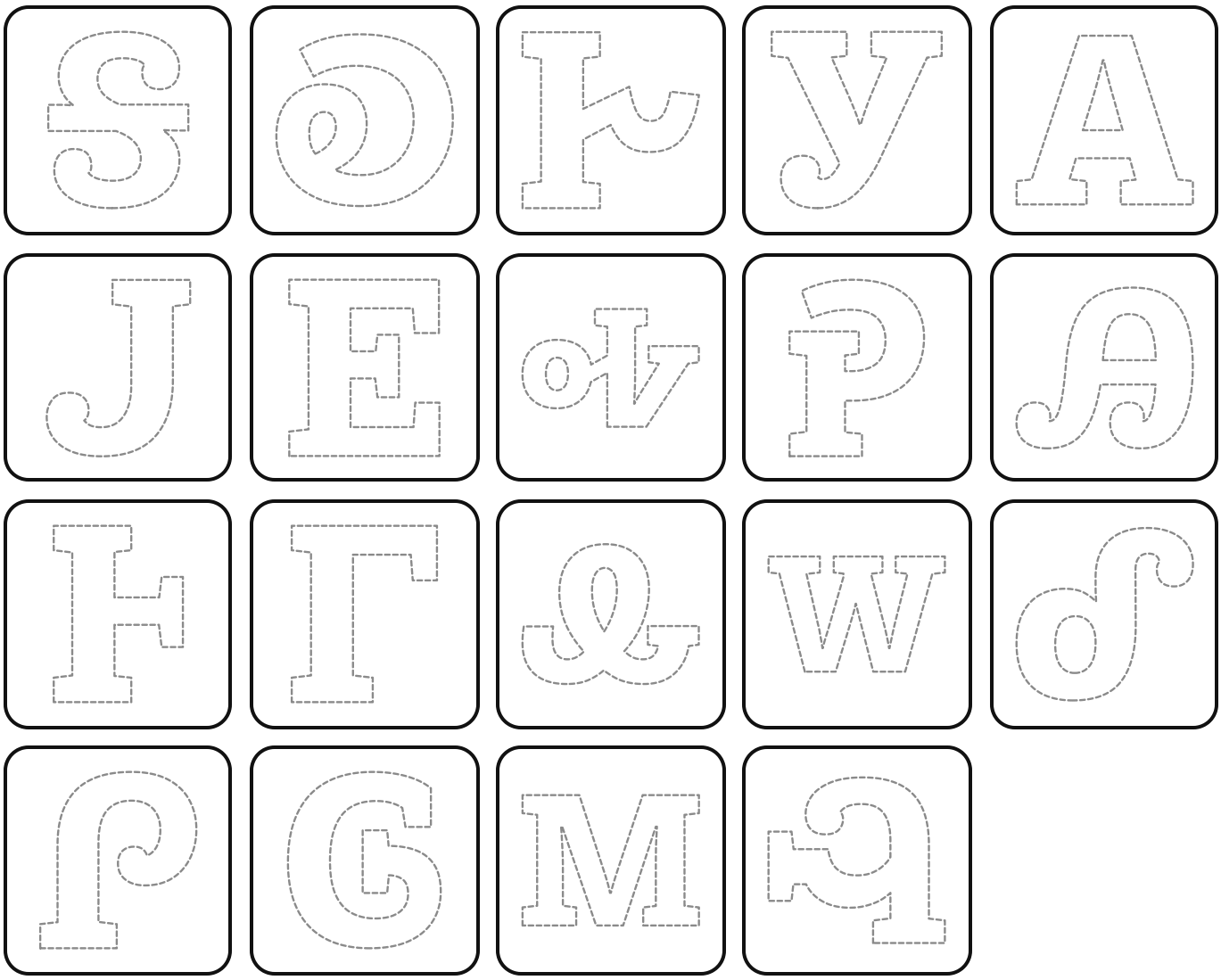
Ꮣ *ga*	Ꭰ *ka*	Ꮀ *ge*	Ꮄ *gi*	Ꭿ *go*	Ꭻ *gu*	Ꭼ *gv*
Ꮻ *ha*	Ᏼ *he*	Ꮉ *hi*	Ꮋ *ho*	Ꮁ *hu*	Ꮎ *hv*	
W *la*	Ꮭ *le*	Ꮅ *li*	Ꮆ *lo*	M *lu*	Ꮓ *lv*	

Two signs for ‘ga’ and ‘ka’
The G row has one extra sign: **Ꮣ ga** and **Ꭰ ka**. For the other vowels, G and K share one sign (Ꮀ can sound like *ge* or *ke*).

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace g, k, h and l S ov W

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



Ꮍ

NAME · SVi

Ꮍ

ga

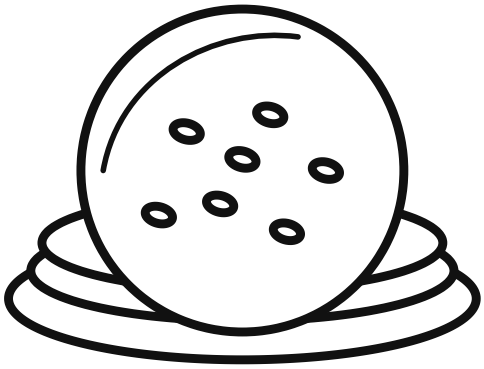
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‘g’ as in “go” + ‘ah’ as in “father”
→ **gah**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮍ	Ꭰ	Ꮉ	Ꭹ	Ꭺ	Ꭻ	Ꭼ
ga	ka	ge	gi	go	gu	gv

The box shows this sign in **the G / K row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꮍ IS FOR

ᏍᏍ

gah-doo

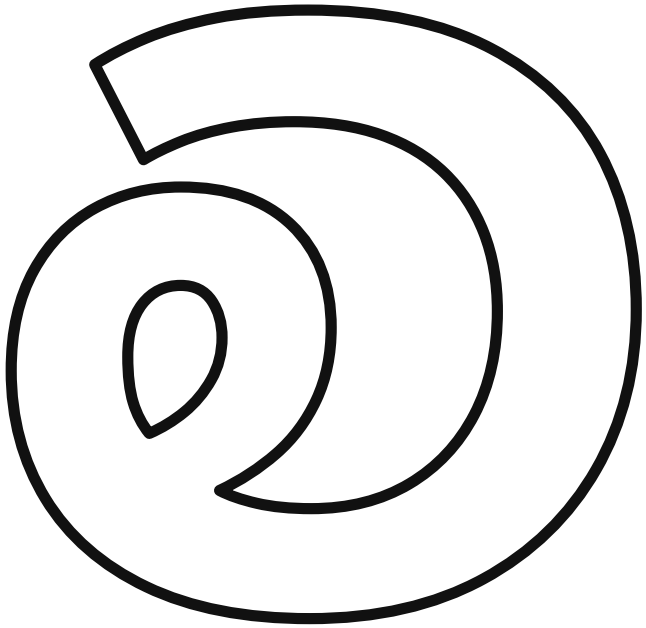
bread

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏰᎳᎳᏔ

Ꮍ Ꮍ Ꮍ Ꮍ

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NAME · SVi

Ꭿ

ka

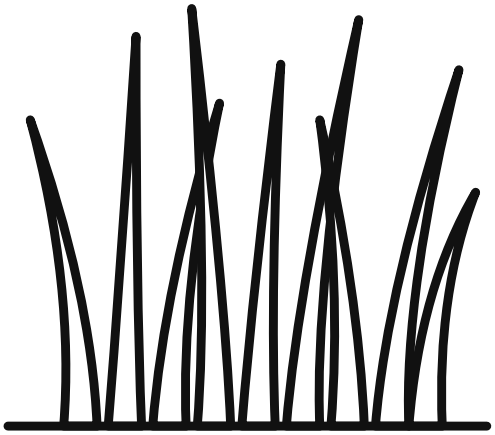
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite” + ‘ah’ as in “father” → **kah**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮣ	Ꭿ	Ꮉ	Ꮍ	Ꭰ	Ꭻ	Ꭼ
ga	ka	ge	gi	go	gu	gv

The box shows this sign in **the G / K row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꭿ IS FOR

ᎧᏃᎮᎢ

kah-nehs-gah

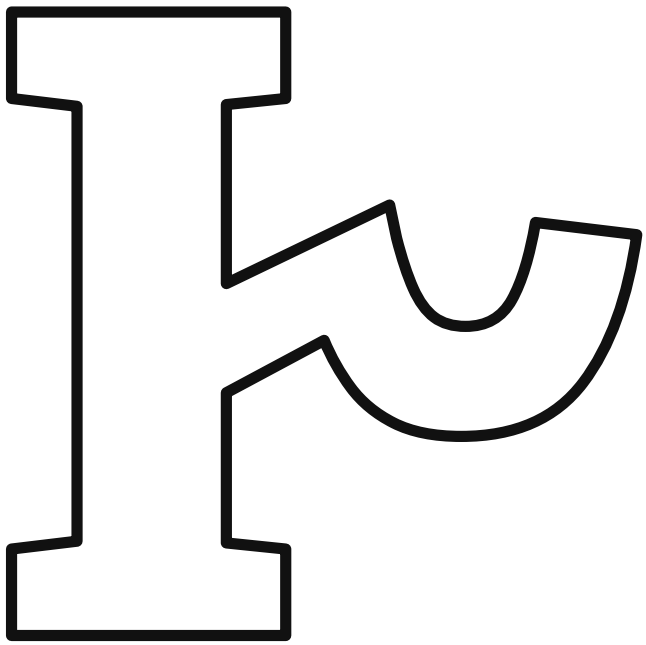
grass, hay

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏓᏔᏅ

Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ

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NAME · SVi

Ꮁ

ge

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

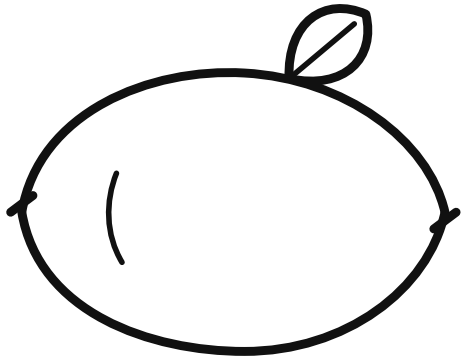
‘g’ as in “go” + ‘eh’ as in “bed” → **geh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮣ	Ꭿ	Ꮁ	Ꭹ	A	J	E
ga	ka	ge	gi	go	gu	gv

The box shows this sign in **the G / K row** of the syllabary chart.

Ꮁ (ge) is the last sound of many colour words: ᏏᎶᏂᏁ yellow, ᎩᏍᏁ red, ᎬᎾᏁ black.



Ꮁ IS FOR

ᏏᎶᏂᏁ

dah-loh-nee-geh

yellow — color the lemon yellow!

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · AᏯᏫW

Ꮁ Ꮁ Ꮁ Ꮁ

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Ꭹ

NAME · SVi

Ꭹ

gi

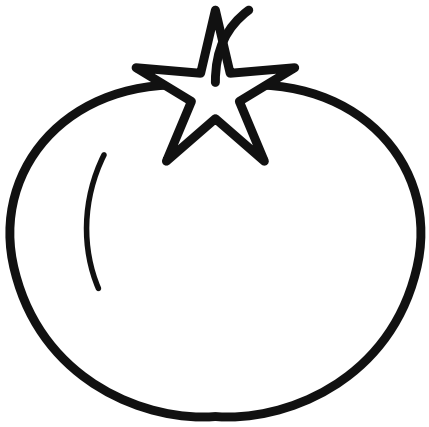
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go” + ‘ee’ as in “see” → **gee**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮣ	Ꭿ	Ꮉ	**Ꭹ**	Ꭺ	Ꭻ	Ꭼ
ga	ka	ge	**gi**	go	gu	gv

The box shows this sign in **the G / K row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꭹ IS FOR

ᎩᏍᏉ

gee-gah-geh

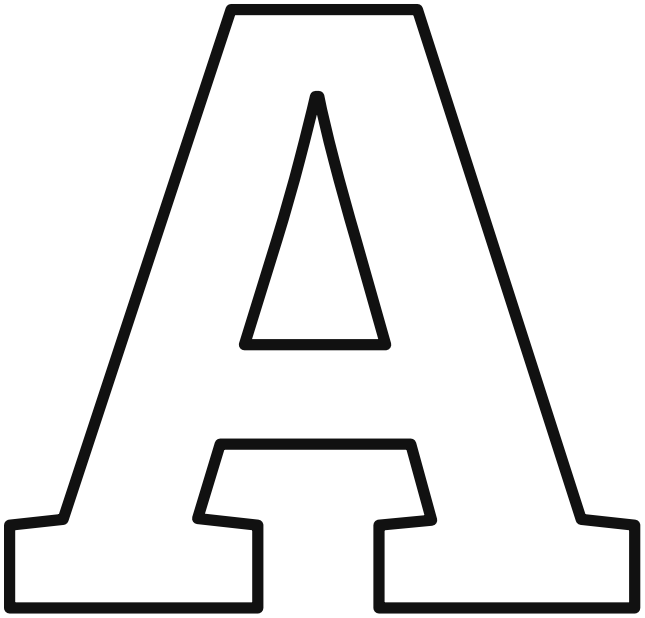
red — color the tomato red!

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎯᏓᎩᎳ

Ꭹ Ꭹ Ꭹ Ꭹ

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NAME · SVi

A

go

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go” + ‘oh’ as in “go” → **goh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮣ	Ꭰ	Ꮅ	Ꭹ	**Ꭺ**	Ꭻ	Ꭼ
ga	ka	ge	gi	**go**	gu	gv

The box shows this sign in **the G / K row** of the syllabary chart.



A IS FOR

ᎠᏰᎵ

goh-weh-lee

paper, a book, a letter

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏰᎳ

A A A A

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Ꭻ

NAME · SVi

J

gu

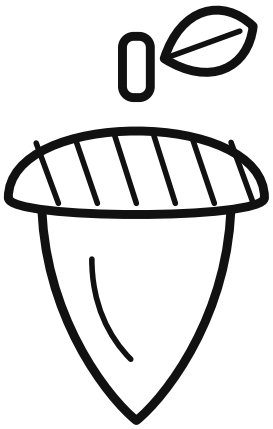
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go” + ‘oo’ as in “moon”
→ **goo**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮣ	Ꭿ	Ꮁ	Ꭹ	Ꭺ	Ꭻ	Ꭼ
ga	ka	ge	gi	go	gu	gv

The box shows this sign in **the G / K row** of the syllabary chart.



J IS FOR

JᏧ

goo-leh

acorn

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · AᏯᎳW

Ꭻ Ꭻ Ꭻ Ꭻ

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Ꭼ

NAME · SVi

Ꭼ

gv

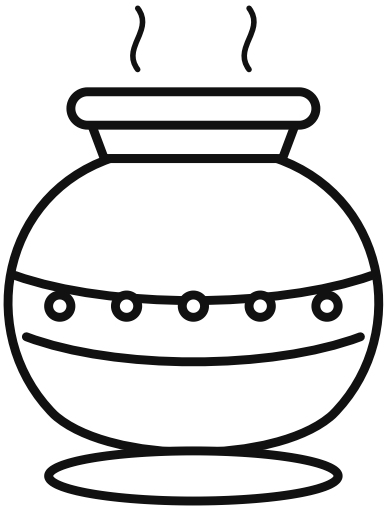
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go” + ‘uh’ said through the nose, like a humming “uh” → **guhn**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮆ	Ꮄ	Ꮉ	Ꮍ	Ꭰ	Ꭻ	Ꭼ
ga	ka	ge	gi	go	gu	gv

The box shows this sign in **the G / K row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꭼ IS FOR

ᎬᎾᏂ

guhn-nah-geh

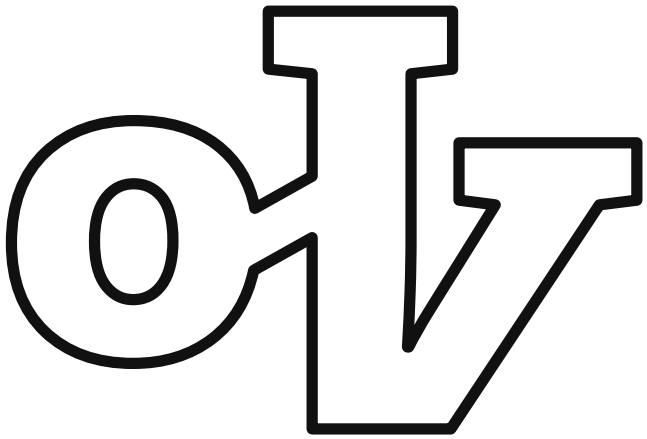
black — color the pot black!

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏍᏫᎳ

Ꭼ Ꭼ Ꭼ Ꭼ

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NAME · SVi

ᎭᏉ

ha

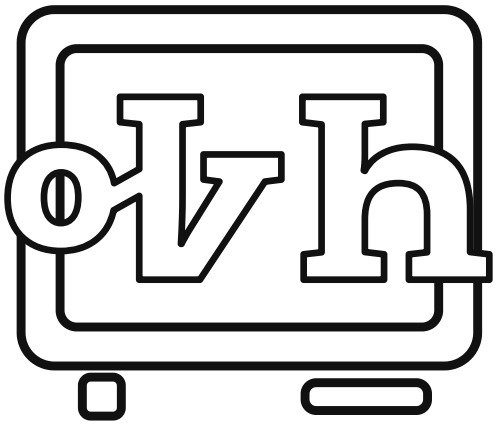
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat” + ‘ah’ as in “father”
→ **hah**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

ᎭᏉ	Ᏹ	Ꭿ	Ꮋ	Ꮐ	Ꮻ
ha	he	hi	ho	hu	hv

The box shows this sign in **the H row** of the syllabary chart.



ᎭᏉ IS FOR

ᎭᏉh

hah-nee

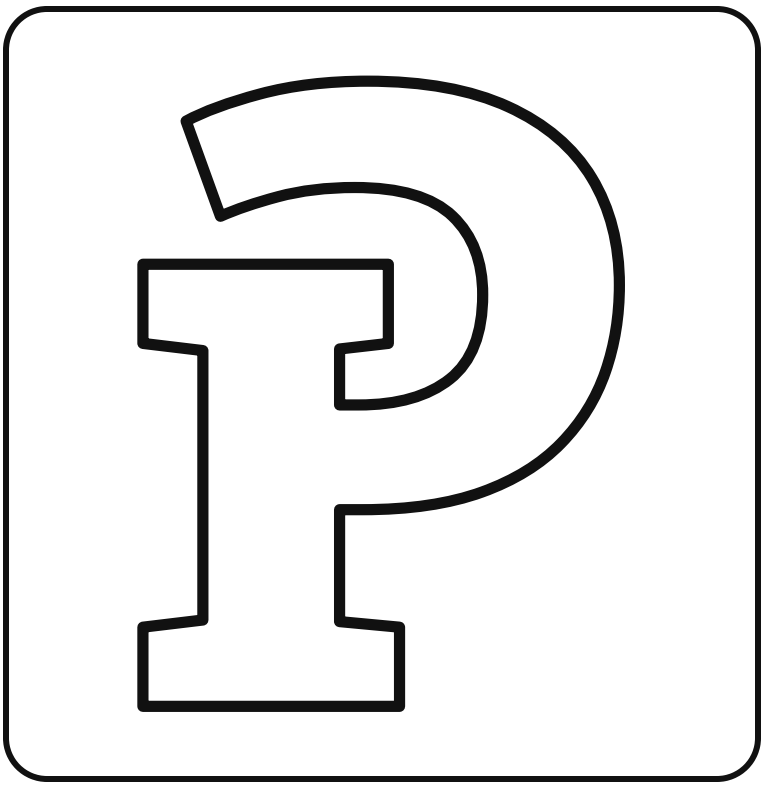
here

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

ᎭᏉ ᎭᏉ ᎭᏉ ᎭᏉ

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NAME · SVi

Ᏼ

he

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

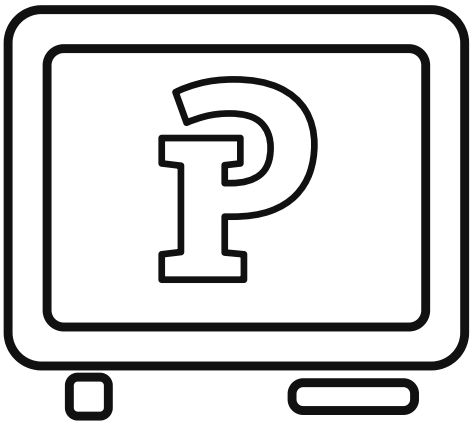
‘h’ as in “hat” + ‘eh’ as in “bed”
→ **heh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

ᎭᏉ	**[Ᏼ]**	Ꭿ	Ꮀ	Ꮁ	Ꮆ
ha	**[he]**	hi	ho	hu	hv

The box shows this sign in **the H row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ᏼ IS FOR

Ᏼ

heh

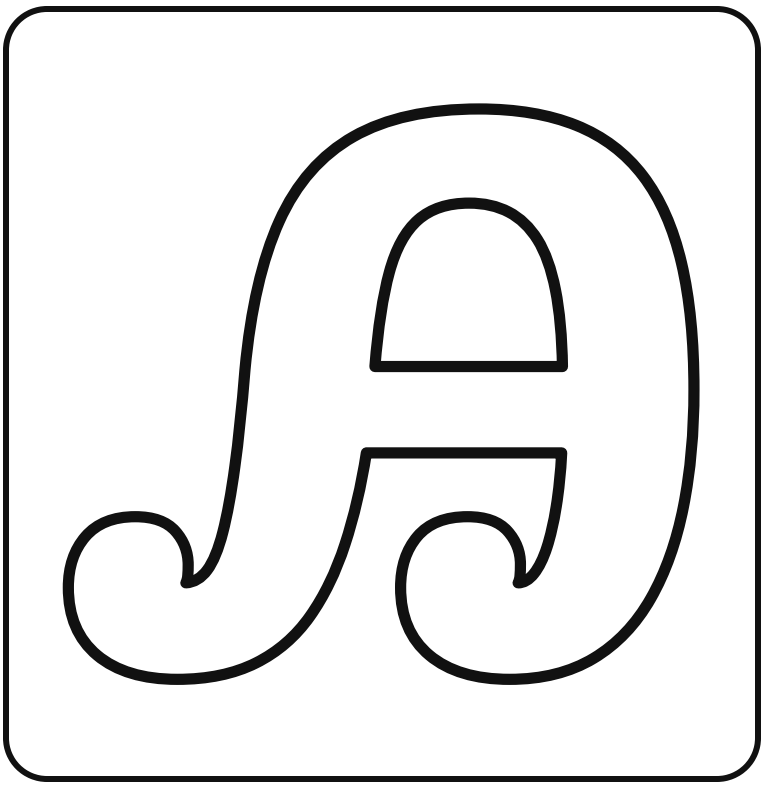
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

Ᏼ Ᏼ Ᏼ Ᏼ

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NAME · SVi

Ꭰ

hi

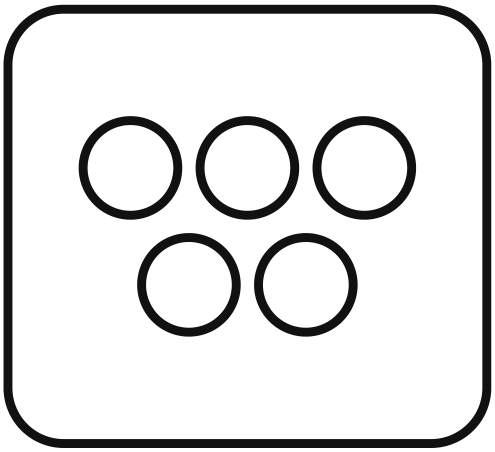
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat” + ‘ee’ as in “see” → **hee**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

ꭶ	Ꮲ	**Ꭰ**	Ꮀ	Ꮁ	Ꮆ
ha	he	**hi**	ho	hu	hv

The box shows this sign in **the H row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꭰ IS FOR

ᎯᏍᎩ

hees-gee

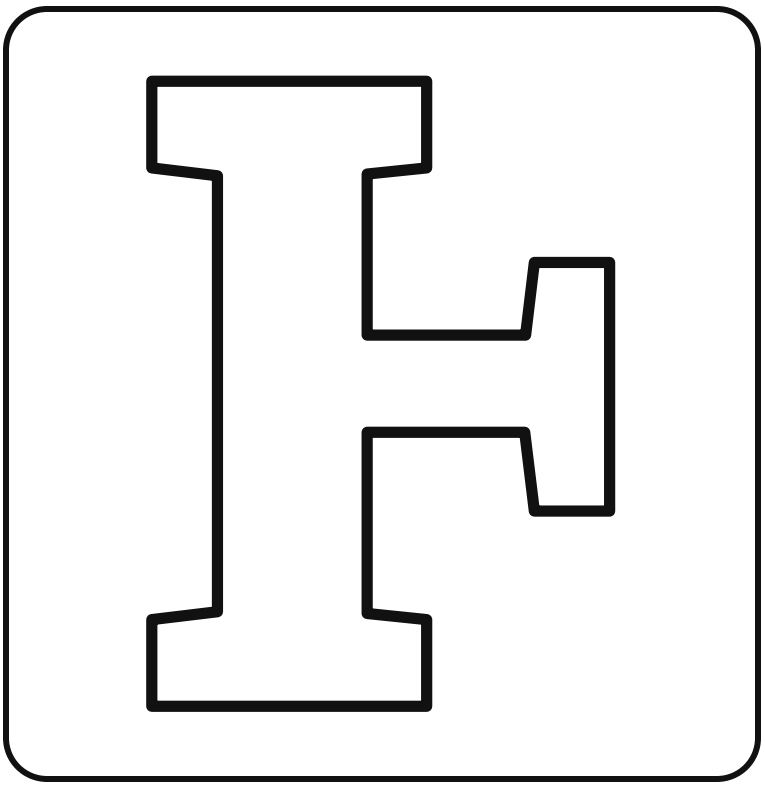
five — count 5 pebbles

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏰᎳ

Ꭰ Ꭰ Ꭰ Ꭰ

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NAME · SVi

Ꮋ

ho

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

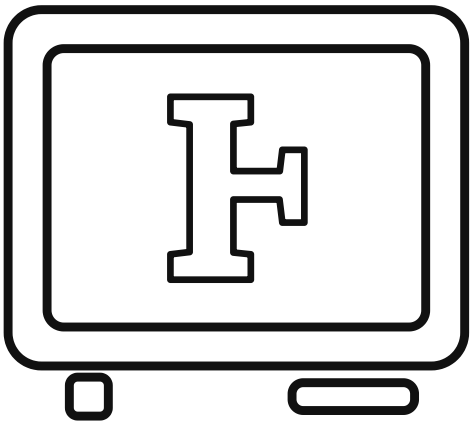
‘h’ as in “hat” + ‘oh’ as in “go” → **hoh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

ꭶ	Ꮲ	Ꭿ	**Ꮋ**	Ꮗ	Ꮾ
ha	he	hi	**ho**	hu	hv

The box shows this sign in **the H row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꮋ IS FOR

Ꮋ

hoh

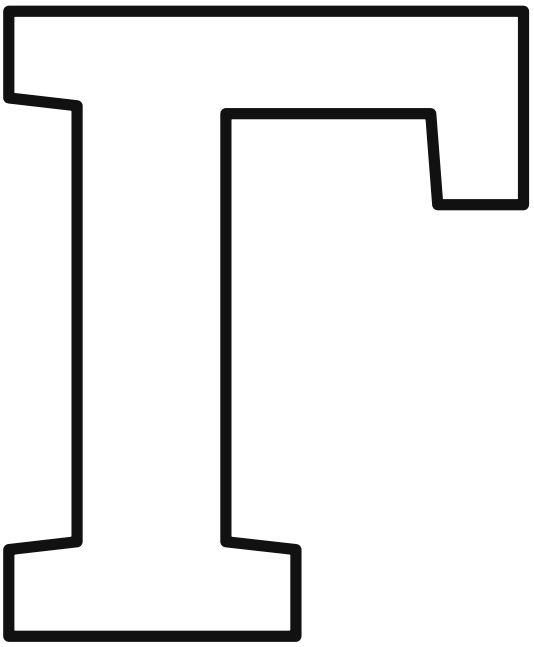
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · AᏍᎱᏔ

Ꮋ Ꮋ Ꮋ Ꮋ

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NAME · SVi

Γ

hu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

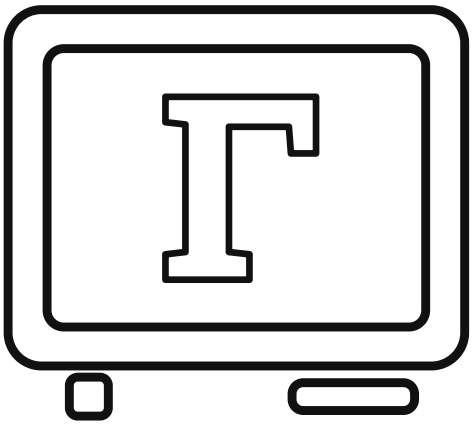
‘h’ as in “hat” + ‘oo’ as in “moon” → **hoo**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

ha	he	hi	ho	hu	hv
Ꭰ	Ꮲ	Ꭿ	Ꮋ	**Γ**	Ꮸ

The box shows this sign in **the H row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Γ IS FOR

Γ

hoo

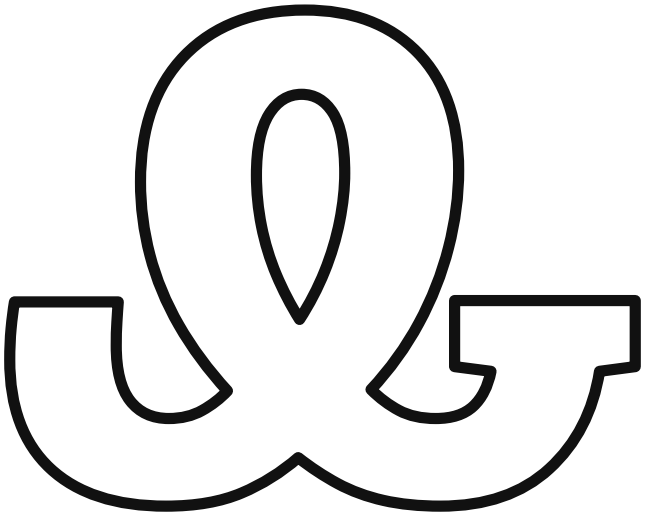
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏍᎩᎳ

Γ Γ Γ Γ

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NAME · SVi

Ꭿ

hv

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat” + ‘uh’ said through the nose, like a humming “uh” → **huhn**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

ꭶ	Ꮲ	Ꭷ	Ꮀ	Ꮁ	Ꭿ
ha	he	hi	ho	hu	hv

The box shows this sign in **the H row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꭿ IS FOR

Ꭿ

huhn

sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏰᎳ

Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ

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Ꮗ

NAME · SVi

Ꮗ

la

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

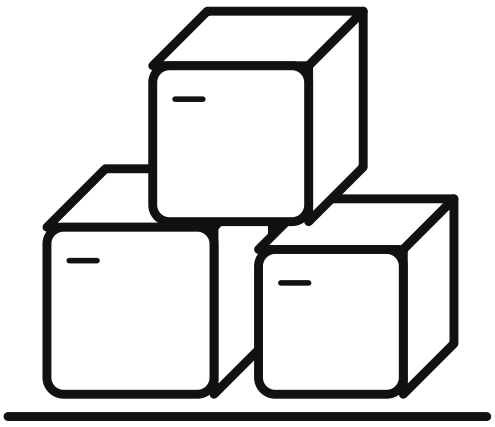
‘l’ as in “lamp” + ‘ah’ as in “father” → **lah**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮗ	ᏼ	Ꮲ	Ꮾ	Ꮿ	Ᏹ
la	le	li	lo	lu	lv

The box shows this sign in **the L row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Ꮗ are rare, so find Ꮗ **inside** ᎤᏁᏍᏆᏤᎳ (u-ne-s-da-**la**).



Ꮗ IS FOR

ᎤᏁᏍᏆᏤᎳ

oo-nehs-dah-lah

ice

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · AᏓᏩᎳ

Ꮗ Ꮗ Ꮗ Ꮗ

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ᎴᏍᎩ

NAME · SVi

ᎴᏍᎩ

le

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

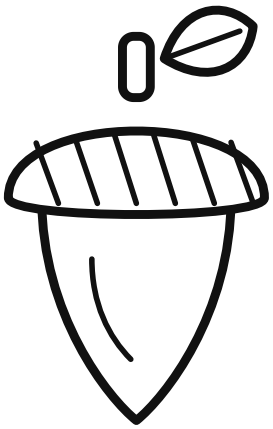
'l' as in "lamp" + 'eh' as in "bed"
→ **leh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮗ	**ᎴᏍᎩ**	�below	Ꮆ	Ꮇ	Ꮘ
la	**le**	li	lo	lu	lv

The box shows this sign in **the L row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with ᎴᏍᎩ are rare, so find ᎴᏍᎩ **inside** ᎫᎴᏍᎩ (gu-**le**).



ᎴᏍᎩ IS FOR

ᎫᎴᏍᎩ

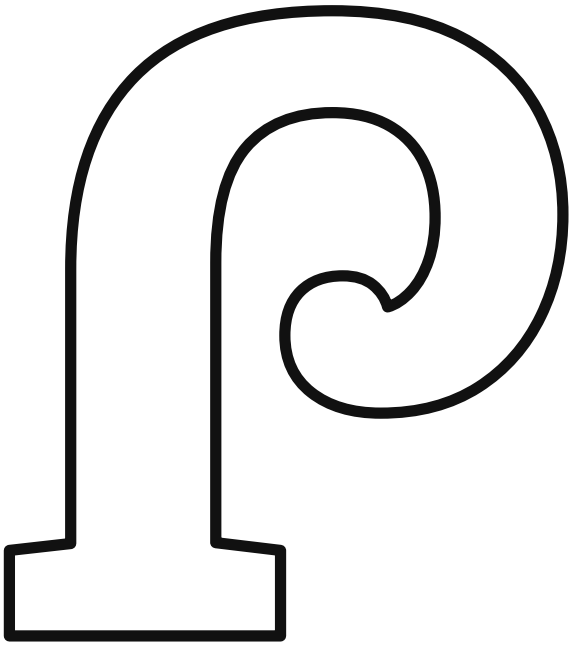
goo-leh

acorn

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏁ

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NAME · SVi

Ꮅ

li

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

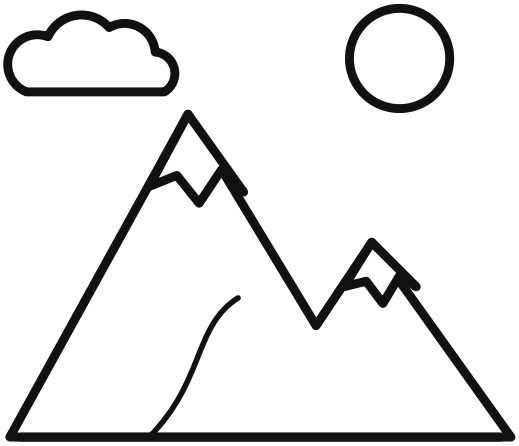
‘l’ as in “lamp” + ‘ee’ as in “see”
→ **lee**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮗ	Ꮘ	**Ꮅ**	Ꮆ	Ꮇ	Ꮓ
la	le	**li**	lo	lu	lv

The box shows this sign in **the L row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Ꮅ are rare, so find Ꮅ **inside** ᎧᏓᏅ (o-da-**li**).



Ꮅ IS FOR

ᎧᏓᏅ

oh-dah-lee

mountain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

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Ꮆ

NAME · SVi

Ꮆ

lo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

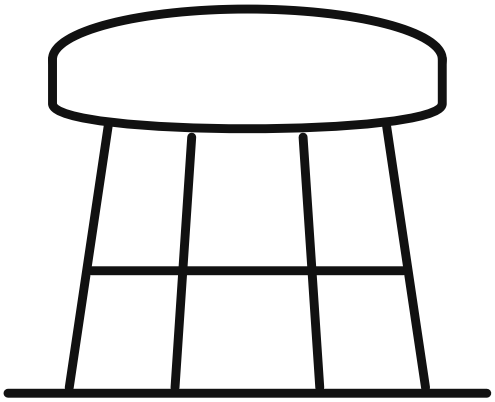
‘l’ as in “lamp” + ‘oh’ as in “go” → **loh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮗ	Ꮄ	Ꮅ	**Ꮆ**	Ꮇ	Ꮟ
la	le	li	**lo**	lu	lv

The box shows this sign in **the L row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Ꮆ are rare, so find Ꮆ **inside** ᏕᎧᏃᎶ (ga-s-gi-**lo**).



Ꮆ IS FOR

ᏕᎧᏃᎶ

gahs-gee-loh

table, chair

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏰᏫᎳ

Ꮆ Ꮆ Ꮆ Ꮆ

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Ꮇ

NAME · SVi

M

lu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

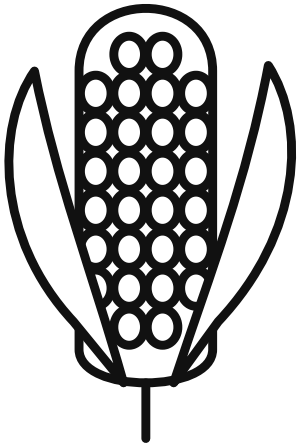
‘l’ as in “lamp” + ‘oo’ as in “moon” → **loo**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮗ	Ꮄ	Ꮅ	Ꮆ	**Ꮇ**	Ꮟ
la	le	li	lo	**lu**	lv

The box shows this sign in **the L row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with M are rare, so find M **inside** 4M (se-**lu**).



M IS FOR

4M

seh-loo

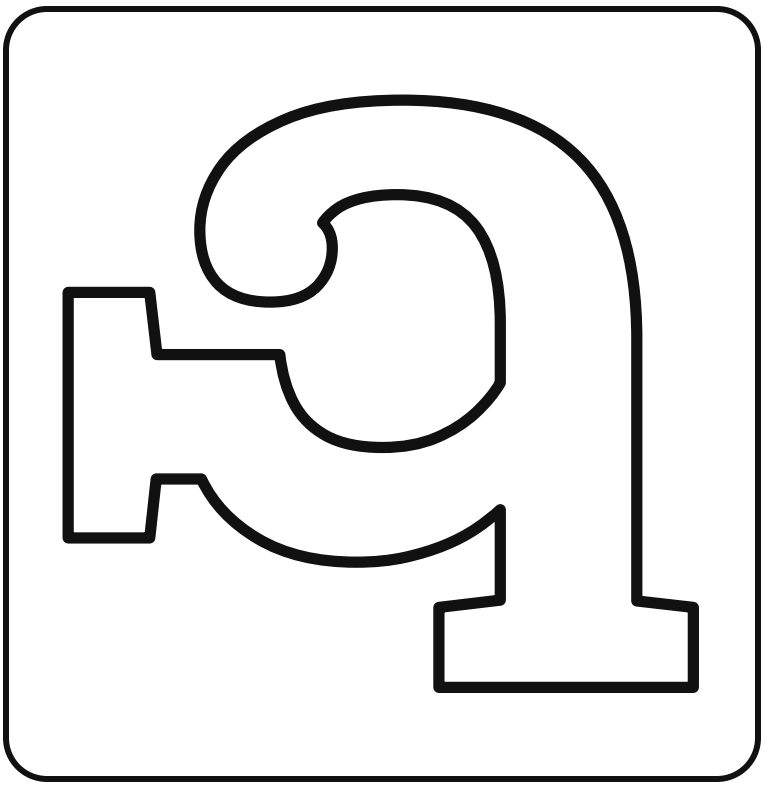
corn

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎸᎳ

M M M M

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NAME · SVi

Ꭿ

lv

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘l’ as in “lamp” + ‘uh’ said through the nose, like a humming “uh” → **luhn**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮗ	Ꮙ	Ꮚ	Ꮜ	Ꮝ	**Ꭿ**
la	le	li	lo	lu	lv

The box shows this sign in **the L row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Ꭿ are rare, so find Ꭿ **inside** ᎠᏂᏍᎩ (a-tsi-**lv**).



Ꭿ IS FOR

ᎠᏂᏍᎩ

ah-jee-luhn

fire

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · AᏯᏫW

Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ

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THE SYLLABARY

M, N and GW Ꮆ Ꮎ Ꮖ

ma · na · qua

Three more rows: **M**, **N** and **GW** (written *qu* in English letters).

Ꮆ *ma*	Ꮋ *me*	Ꮒ *mi*	Ꮓ *mo*	Ꮕ *mu*

Ꮎ *na*	Ꮏ *hna*	Ꮐ *nah*	Ꮑ *ne*	Ꮒ *ni*	Ꮓ *no*	Ꮔ *nu*	Ꮕ *nv*

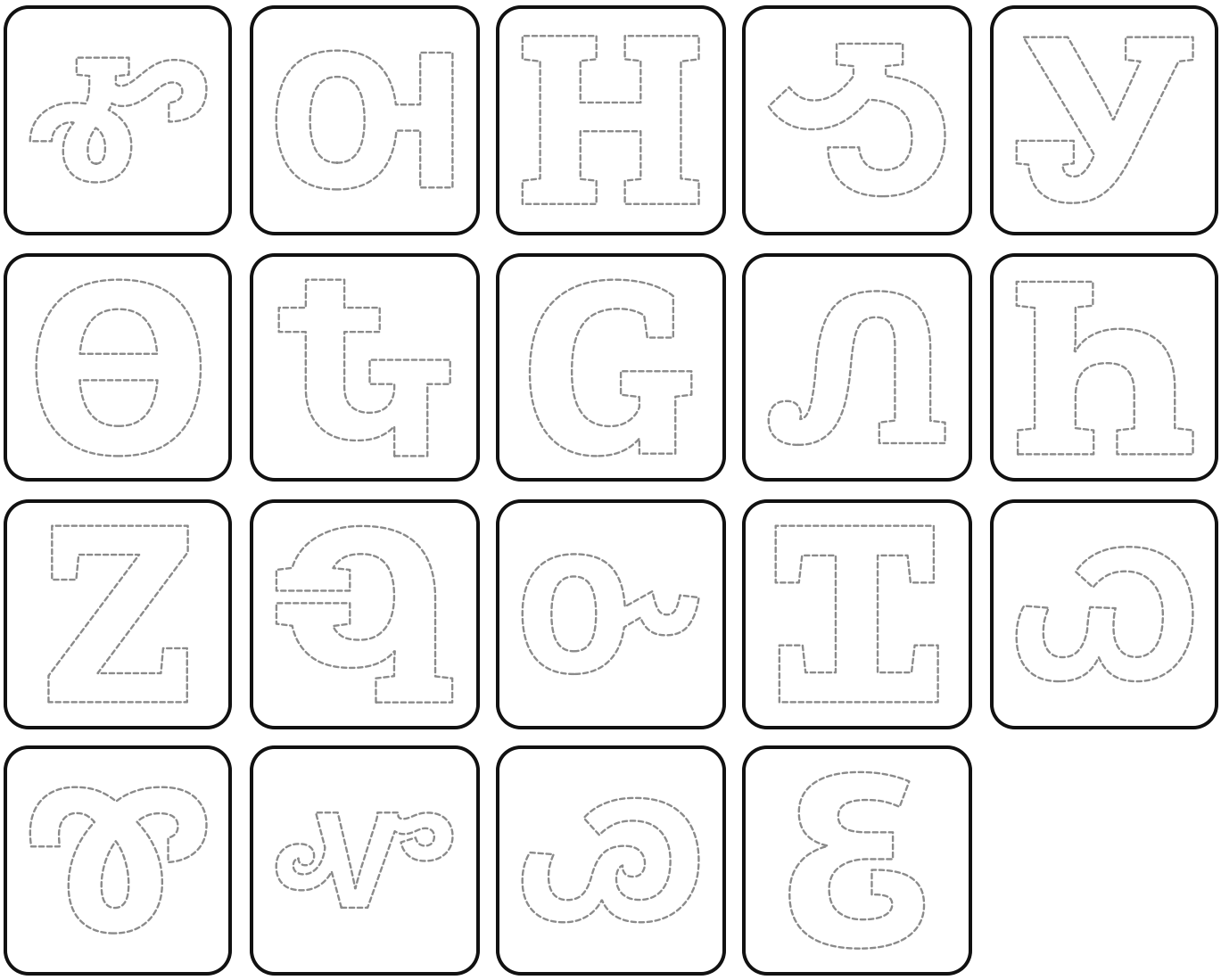
Ꮖ *qua*	Ꮗ *que*	Ꮘ *qui*	Ꮙ *quo*	Ꮚ *quu*	Ꮛ *quv*

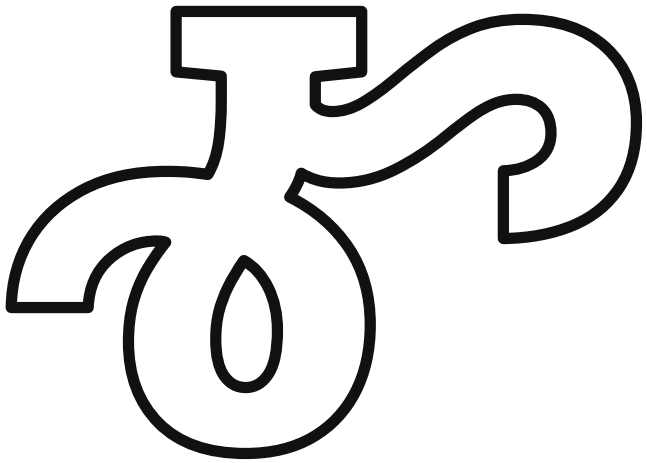
Special signs
The N row has **Ꮏ hna** (a breathy n) and **Ꮐ nah**, an old sign that is hardly ever used now. The M row has only five signs in Sequoyah's chart.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace m, n and gw ᒪ ᐃ ᘐ

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





NAME · SVi

ᎹᏰ

ma

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

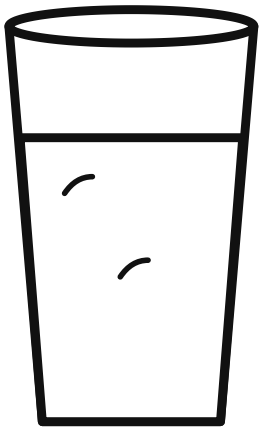
‘m’ as in “moon” + ‘ah’ as in “father” → **mah**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

ᎹᏰ	ᎺᎩ	ᎻᎾ	ᎼᏍ	ᎽᏏ
ma	me	mi	mo	mu

The box shows this sign in **the M row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with ᎹᏰ are rare, so find ᎹᏰ **inside** DᎹᏰ (a-**ma**).



ᎹᏰ IS FOR

DᎹᏰ

ah-mah

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · AᏓᏩW

ᎹᏰ ᎹᏰ ᎹᏰ ᎹᏰ

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Ꭿ

NAME · SVi

Ꭿ

me

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

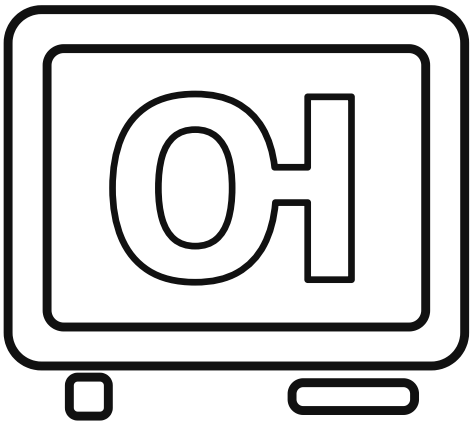
‘m’ as in “moon” + ‘eh’ as in “bed” → **meh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

ᎷᎩ	Ꭿ	ᎻᎯ	ᎹᎲ	ᎽᏍ
ma	me	mi	mo	mu

The box shows this sign in **the M row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꭿ IS FOR

Ꭿ

meh

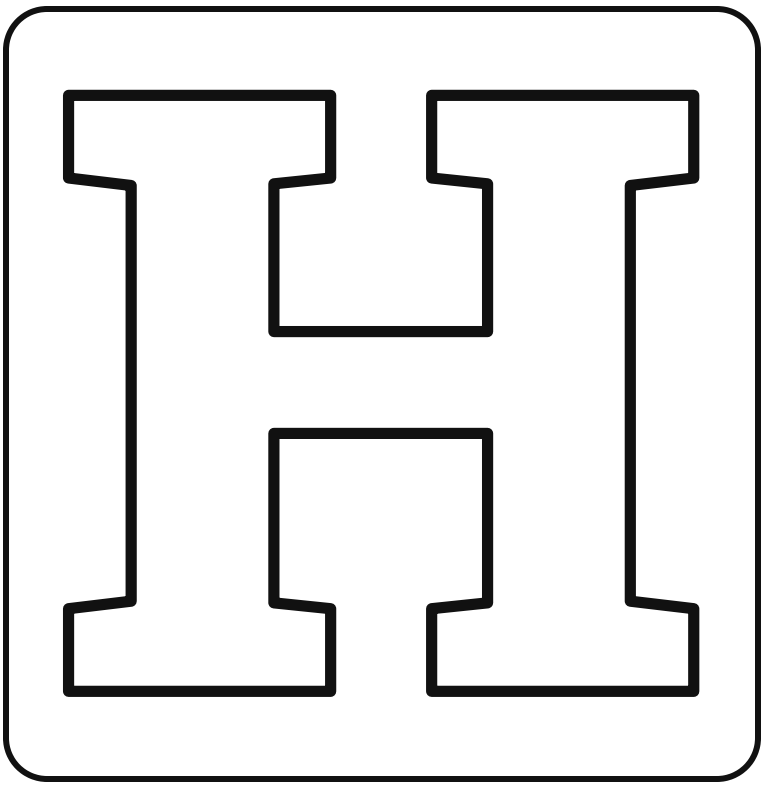
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏰᎳᏔ

Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ

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NAME · SVi

Ꮋ

mi

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

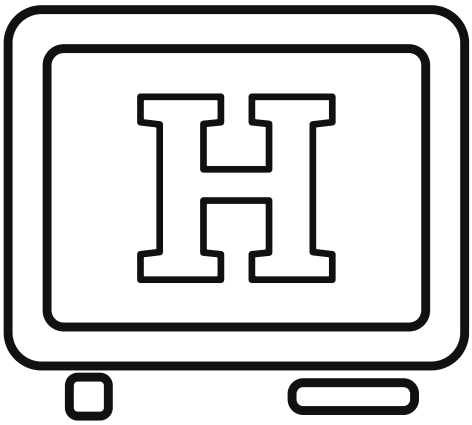
‘m’ as in “moon” + ‘ee’ as in “see” → **mee**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

ᎷᎩ	ᎷᎯ	**Ꮋ**	ᎷᏋ	ᎷᏍ
ma	me	**mi**	mo	mu

The box shows this sign in **the M row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꮋ IS FOR

Ꮋ

mee

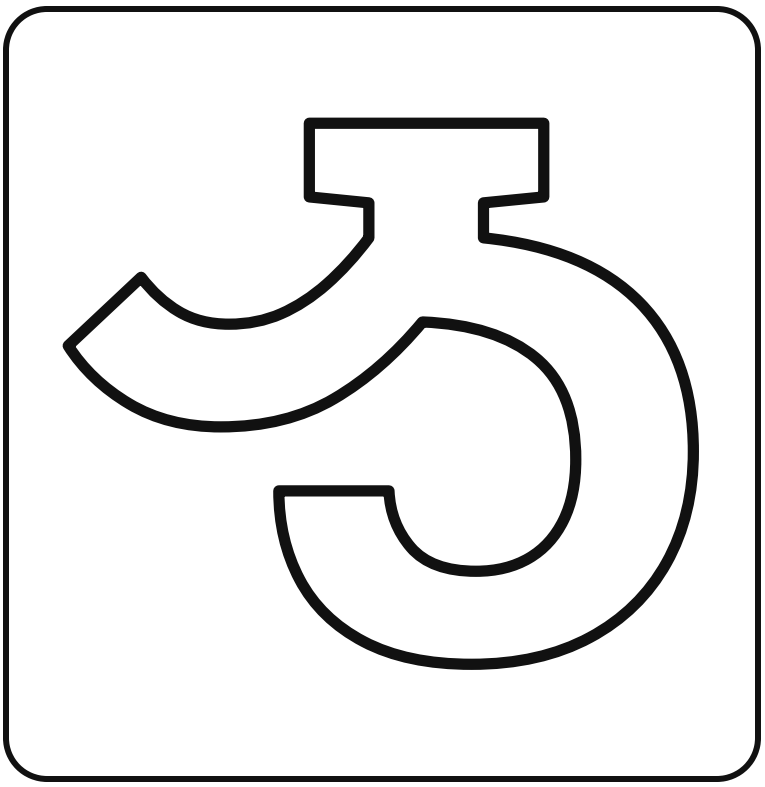
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

Ꮋ Ꮋ Ꮋ Ꮋ

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NAME · SVi

Ꭿ

mo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

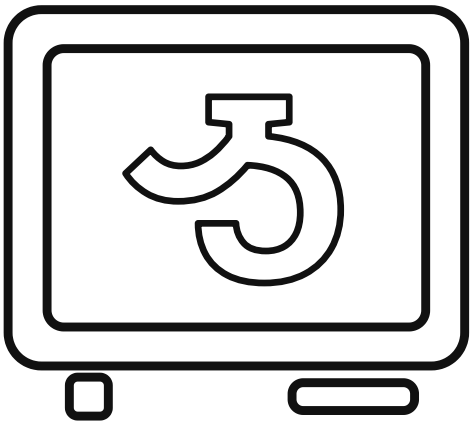
‘m’ as in “moon” + ‘oh’ as in “go” → **moh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮆ	Ꭼ	Ꮋ	Ꭿ	Ꮍ
ma	me	mi	mo	mu

The box shows this sign in **the M row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꭿ IS FOR

Ꭿ

moh

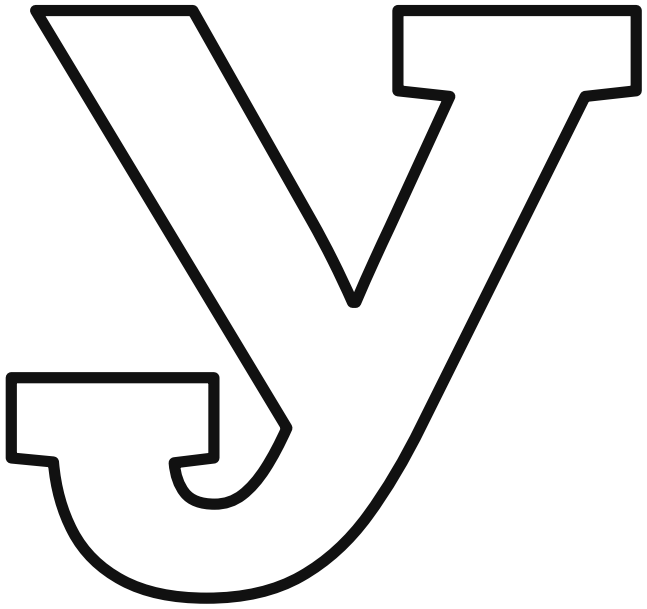
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏰᎳᏔ

Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ

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NAME · SVi

Ꭹ

mu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

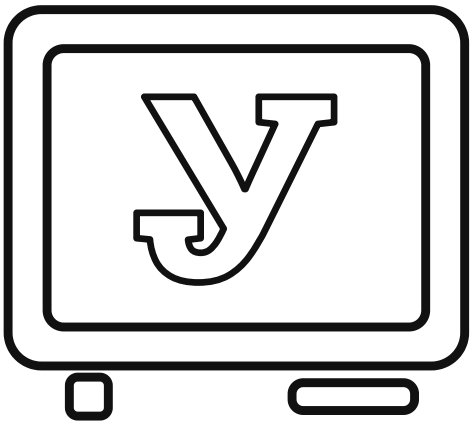
‘m’ as in “moon” + ‘oo’ as in “moon” → **moo**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮆ	Ꮉ	Ꮋ	Ꮓ	Ꭹ
ma	me	mi	mo	mu

The box shows this sign in **the M row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꭹ IS FOR

ꭹ

moo

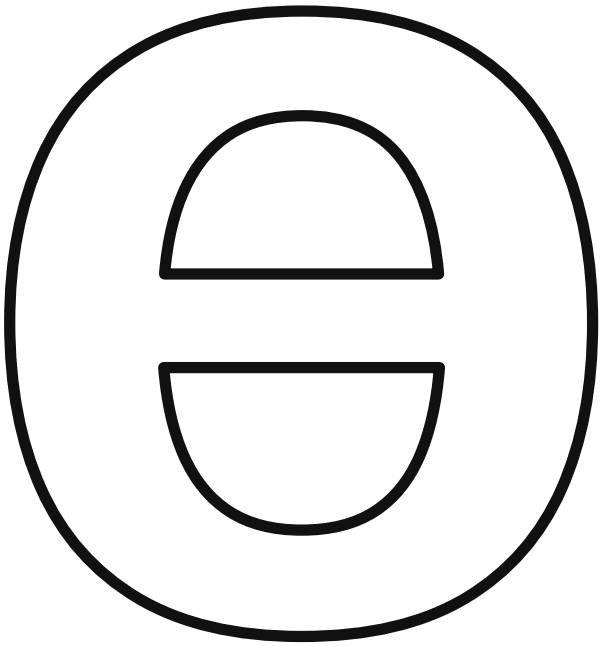
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏰᎳᎳᎳ

ꭹ ꭹ ꭹ ꭹ

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NAME · SVi

Θ

na

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

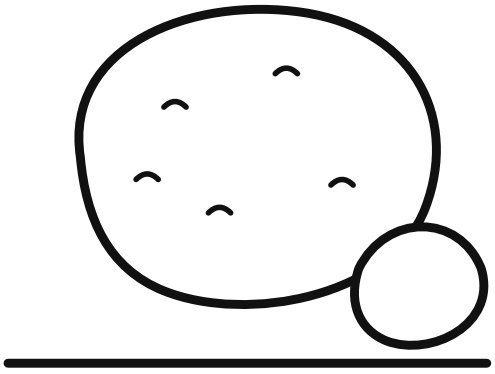
‘n’ as in “net” + ‘ah’ as in “father” → **nah**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Θ	Ꮤ	Ꮆ	Ꮑ	Ꮒ	Ꮓ	Ꮳ	Ꮕ
na	hna	nah	ne	ni	no	nu	nv

The box shows this sign in **the N row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Θ are rare, so find Θ **inside** Ꮳ**Θ** (nu-**na**).



Θ IS FOR

Ꮳ**Θ**

noo-nah

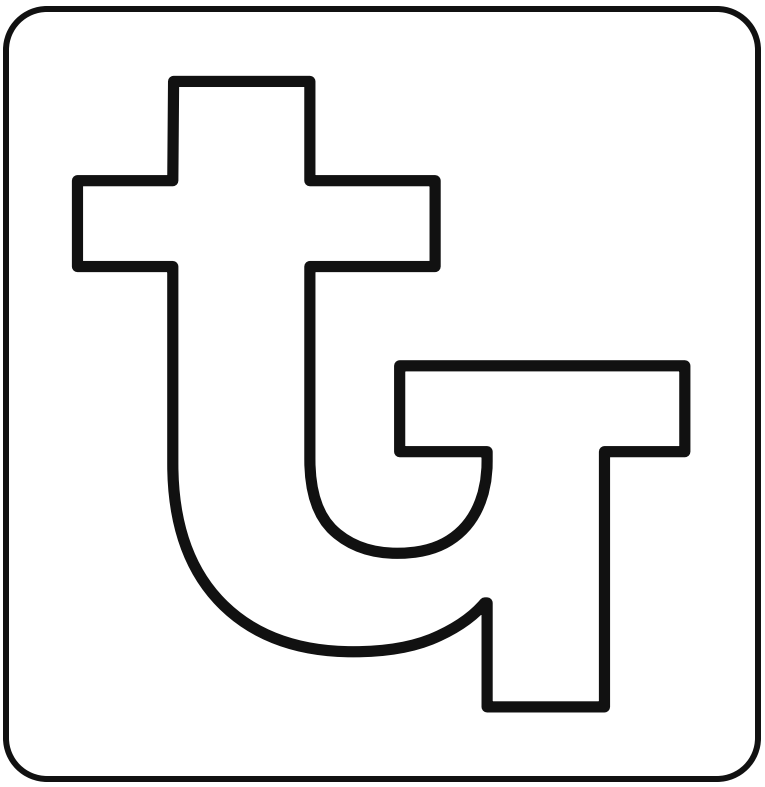
potato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

Θ Θ Θ Θ

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NAME · SVi

ᏂᎦ

hna

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

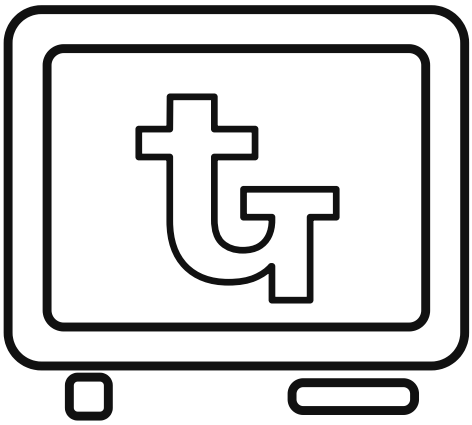
a breathy ‘n’ (blow a little air before the n) + ‘ah’ as in “father” → **hnah**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮎ	**ᏂᎦ**	Ꮆ	Ꮑ	Ꮒ	Ꮓ	Ꮔ	Ꮕ
na	**hna**	nah	ne	ni	no	nu	nv

The box shows this sign in **the N row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



ᏂᎦ IS FOR

ᏂᎦ

hnah

sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

ᏂᎦ ᏂᎦ ᏂᎦ ᏂᎦ

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NAME · SVi

G

nah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'nah' — an old sign for a 'na' sound; today people usually write Θ instead.

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Θ	Ꮦ	**G**	Ꭿ	Ꮒ	Ꮓ	Ꮤ	Ꮹ
na	hna	**nah**	ne	ni	no	nu	nv

The box shows this sign in **the N row** of the syllabary chart.

G is an old sign that is almost never used today. **Sound-practice page.** We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



G IS FOR

G

nah

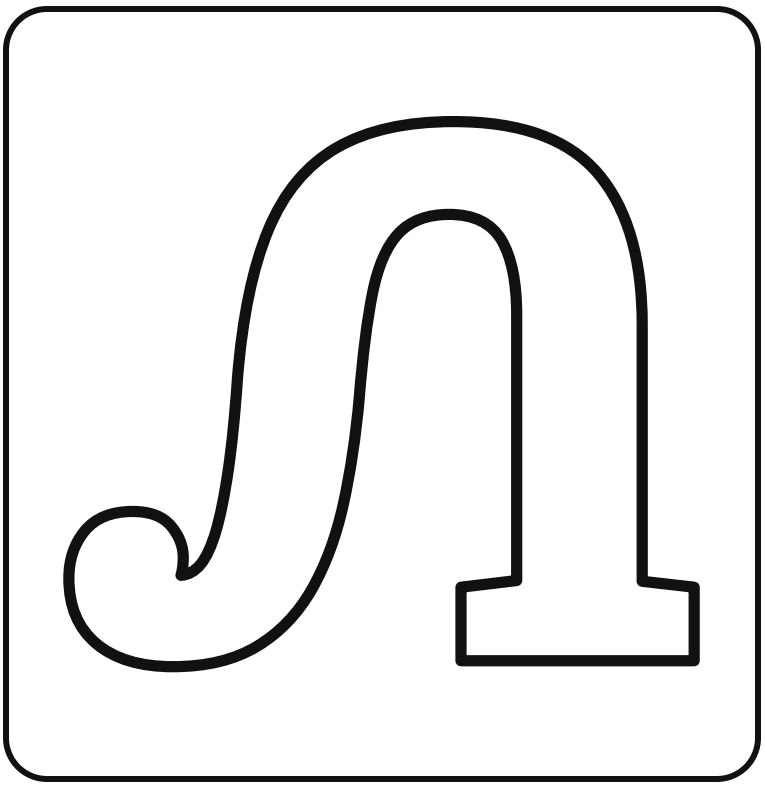
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏁ

G G G G

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NAME · SVi

Ꮑ

ne

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

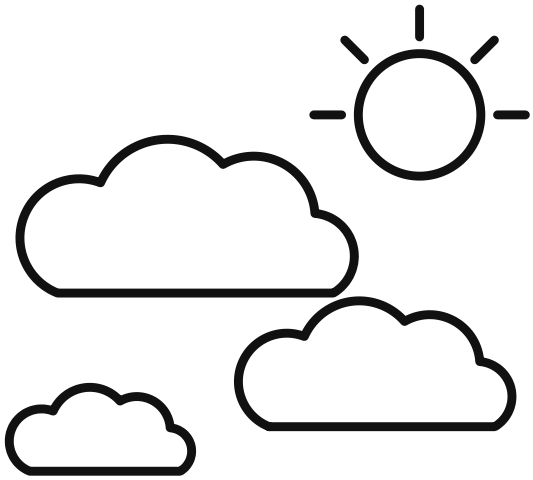
‘n’ as in “net” + ‘eh’ as in “bed”
→ **neh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮎ	Ꮏ	Ꮐ	**Ꮑ**	Ꮒ	Ꮓ	Ꮔ	Ꮕ
na	hna	nah	**ne**	ni	no	nu	nv

The box shows this sign in **the N row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Ꮑ are rare, so find Ꮑ **inside** ᏅᎾᏁᏍ (u-**ne**-ga).



Ꮑ IS FOR

ᏅᎾᏁᏍ

oo-neh-gah

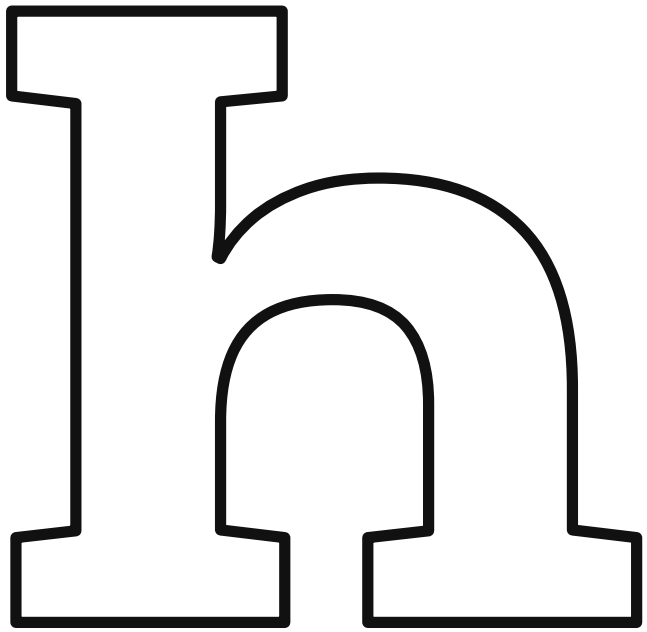
white — like the clouds

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎸᎳ

Ꮑ Ꮑ Ꮑ Ꮑ

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NAME · SVi

Ꮒ

ni

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

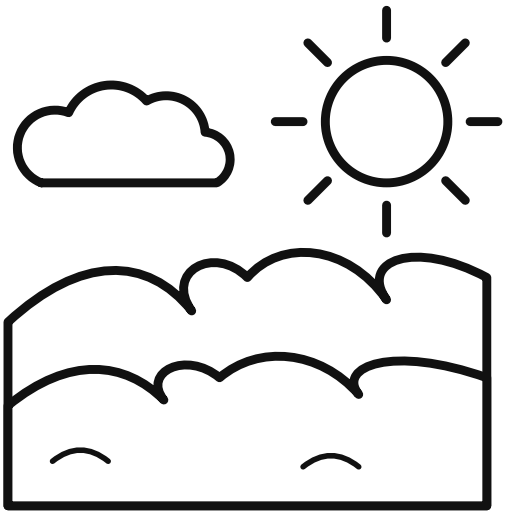
‘n’ as in “net” + ‘ee’ as in “see” → **nee**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮎ	Ꮏ	Ꮐ	Ꮑ	Ꮒ	Ꮓ	Ꮔ	Ꮕ
na	hna	nah	ne	ni	no	nu	nv

The box shows this sign in **the N row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Ꮒ are rare, so find Ꮒ **inside** ᏒᎯᏱᎻ (e-quo-**ni**).



Ꮒ IS FOR

ᏒᎯᏱᎻ

eh-gwoh-nee

river

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

Ꮒ Ꮒ Ꮒ Ꮒ

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Z

NAME · SVi

Z

no

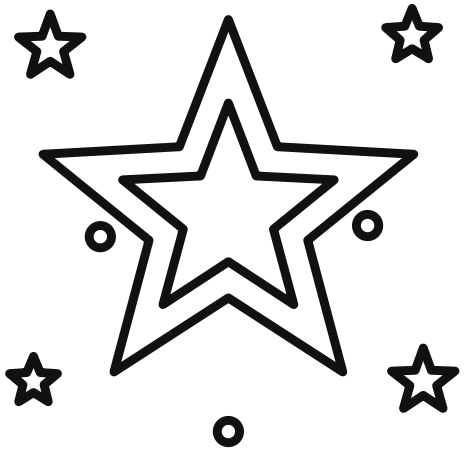
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'n' as in "net" + 'oh' as in "go" → **noh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Θ	Ꮦ	Ꮆ	Ꭿ	Ꮒ	Z	Ꮳ	Ꮕ
na	hna	nah	ne	ni	no	nu	nv

The box shows this sign in **the N row** of the syllabary chart.



Z IS FOR

ZᏫᏏ

noh-gwee-see

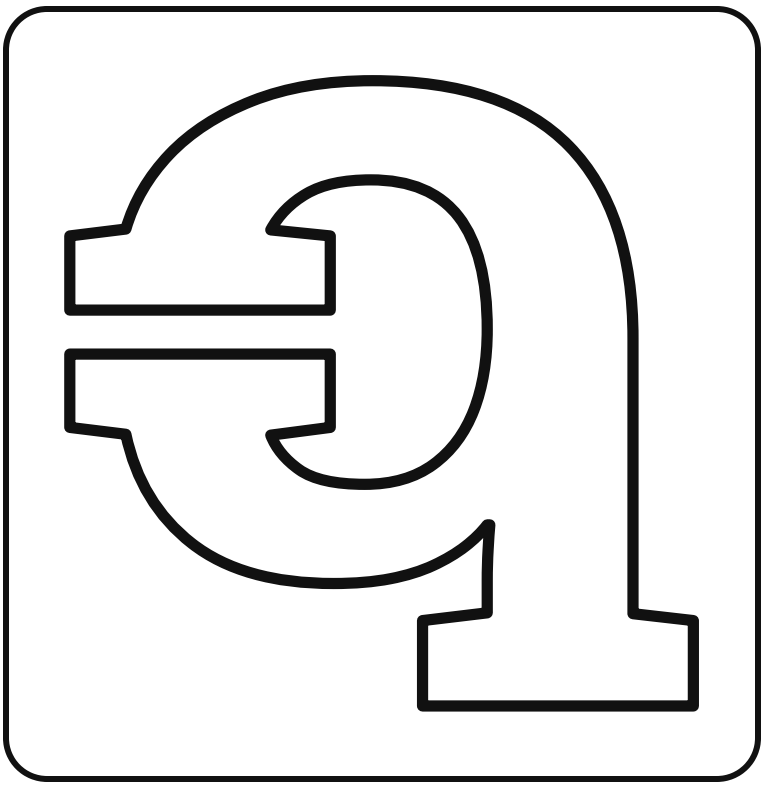
star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎸᎳ

Z Z Z Z

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NAME · SVi

Ꮁ

nu

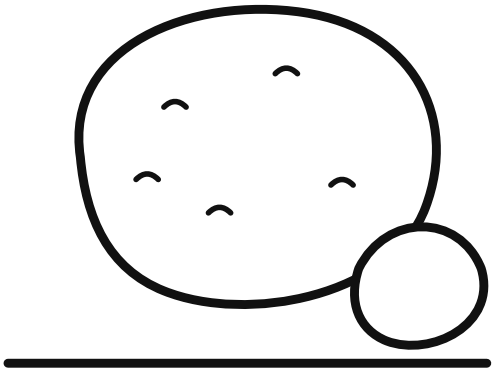
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net” + ‘oo’ as in “moon”
→ **noo**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮎ	Ꮏ	Ꮐ	Ꮑ	Ꮒ	Ꮓ	**Ꮁ**	Ꮕ
na	hna	nah	ne	ni	no	**nu**	nv

The box shows this sign in **the N row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꮁ IS FOR

ᎱᎾ

noo-nah

potato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

Ꮁ Ꮁ Ꮁ Ꮁ

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깳

NAME · SVi

깳

nv

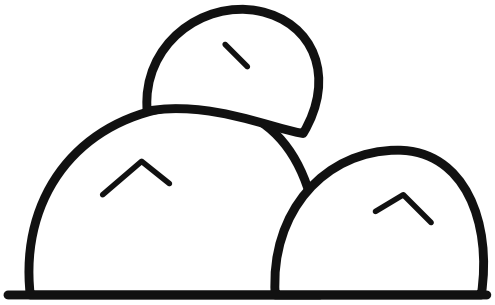
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net” + ‘uh’ said through the nose, like a humming “uh” → **nuhn**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮎ	Ꮏ	Ꮐ	Ꮑ	Ꮒ	Ꮓ	Ꮔ	깳
na	hna	nah	ne	ni	no	nu	nv

The box shows this sign in **the N row** of the syllabary chart.



깳 IS FOR

깳Ꮝ

nuhn-yah

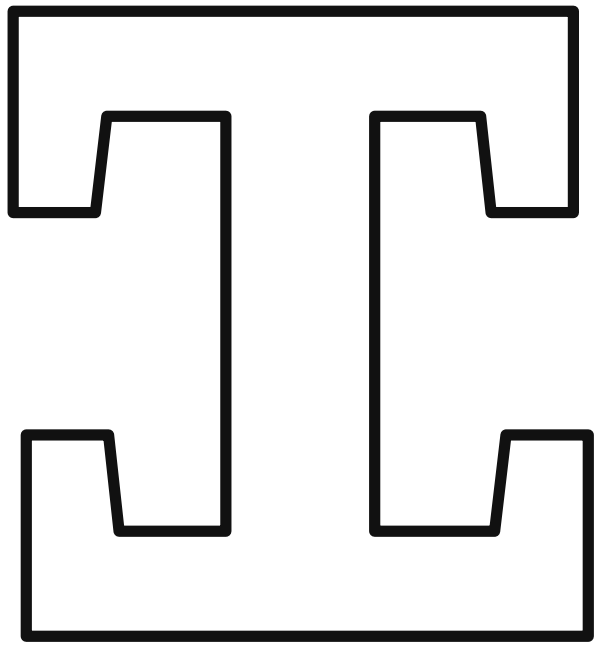
rock, stone

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

깳 깳 깳 깳

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NAME · SVi

Ꭵ

qua

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘gw’ as in “Gwen” (some say ‘kw’ as in “queen”) + ‘ah’ as in “father” → **gwah**

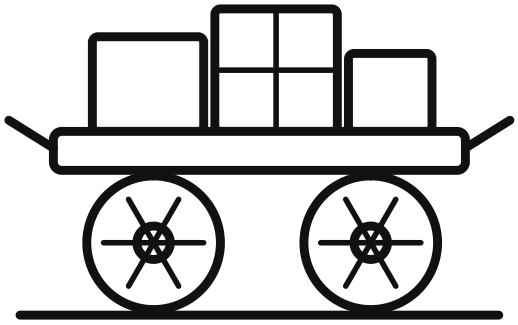
ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭵ	Ꮻ	Ꮼ	Ꮽ	Ꮾ	Ꮿ
qua	que	qui	quo	quu	quv

The box shows this sign in **the GW (QU) row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Ꭵ are rare, so find Ꭵ **inside** ᏓᏆᎴᏅ (da-**qua**-le-lu).

Ꭵ IS FOR



ᏓᏆᎴᏅ

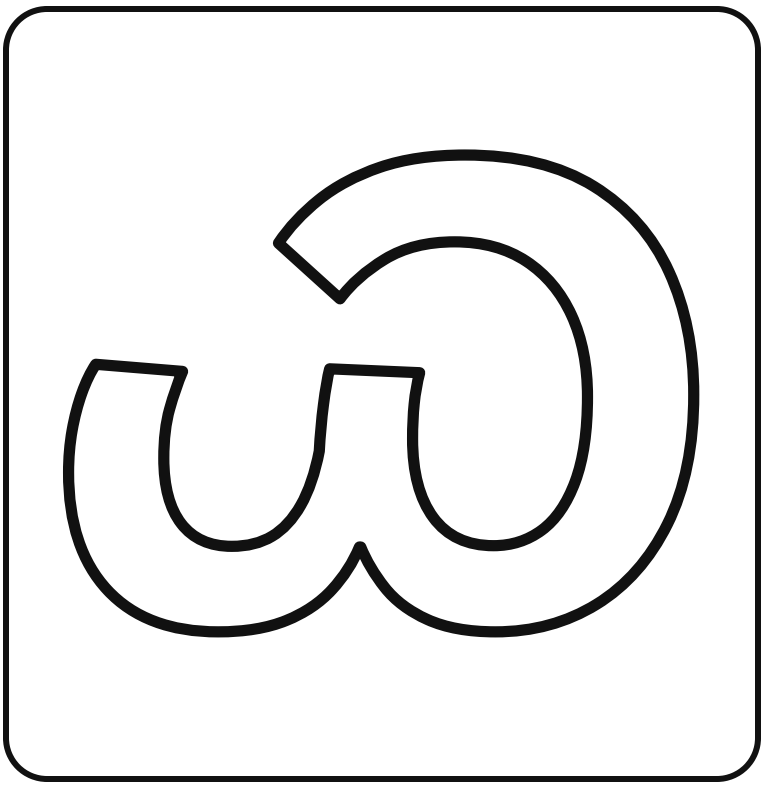
dah-gwah-leh-loo

wagon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏍᏗ

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NAME · SVi

Ꭿ

que

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

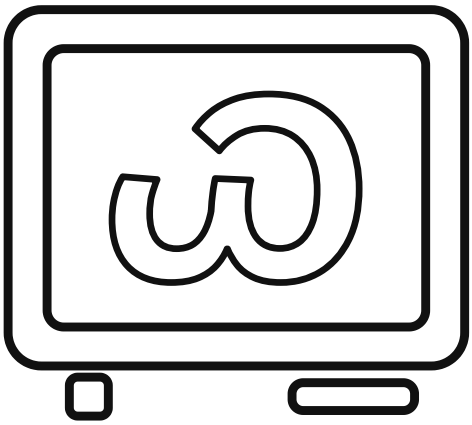
‘gw’ as in “Gwen” (some say ‘kw’ as in “queen”) + ‘eh’ as in “bed” → **gweh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭲ	**Ꭿ**	Ꮁ	Ꮇ	Ꮎ	Ꮐ
qua	**que**	qui	quo	quu	quv

The box shows this sign in **the GW (QU) row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꭿ IS FOR

Ꭿ

gweh

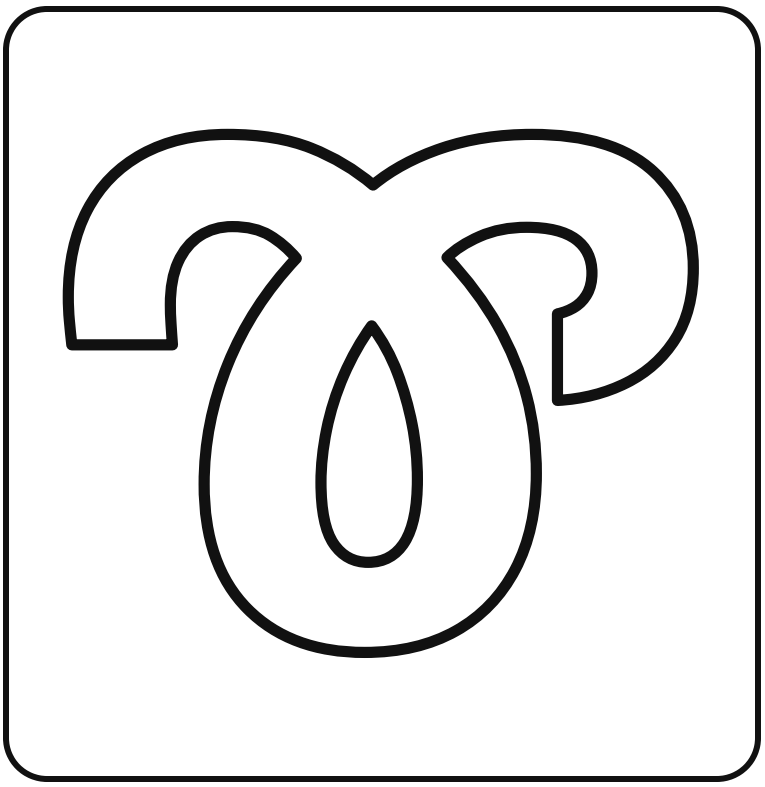
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎯᏪᎳ

Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ

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NAME · SVi

Ꮽ

qui

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

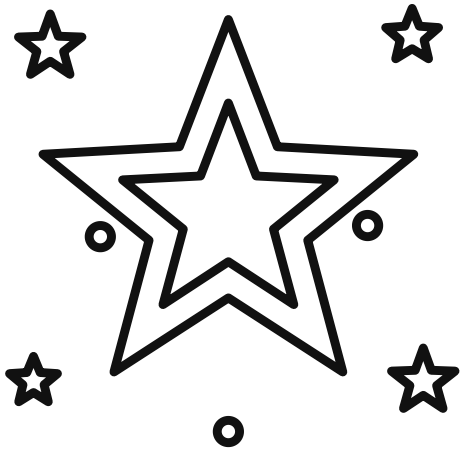
‘gw’ as in “Gwen” (some say ‘kw’ as in “queen”) + ‘ee’ as in “see”
→ **gwee**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭴ	Ꭶ	**Ꮽ**	Ꮿ	Ꮐ	Ꮕ
qua	que	**qui**	quo	quu	quv

The box shows this sign in **the GW (QU) row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Ꮽ are rare, so find Ꮽ **inside** ZᏯᏏ (no-**qui**-si).



Ꮽ IS FOR

ZᏯᏏ

noh-gwee-see

star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · AᏯᎳW

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NAME · SVi

Ꮙᵓ

quo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

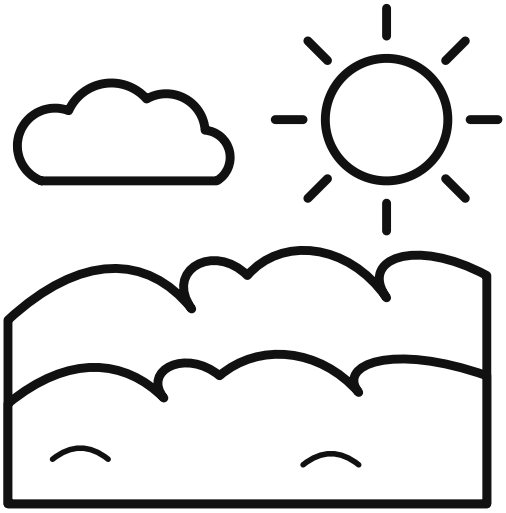
‘gw’ as in “Gwen” (some say ‘kw’ as in “queen”) + ‘oh’ as in “go” → **gwoh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭵ	Ꭿ	Ꮁ	**Ꮙᵓ**	Ꮓ	Ꭼ
qua	que	qui	**quo**	quu	quv

The box shows this sign in **the GW (QU) row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Ꮙᵓ are rare, so find Ꮙᵓ **inside** ᏒᏍᵓᏂ (e-**quo**-ni).



Ꮙᵓ IS FOR

ᏒᏍᵓᏂ

eh-gwoh-nee

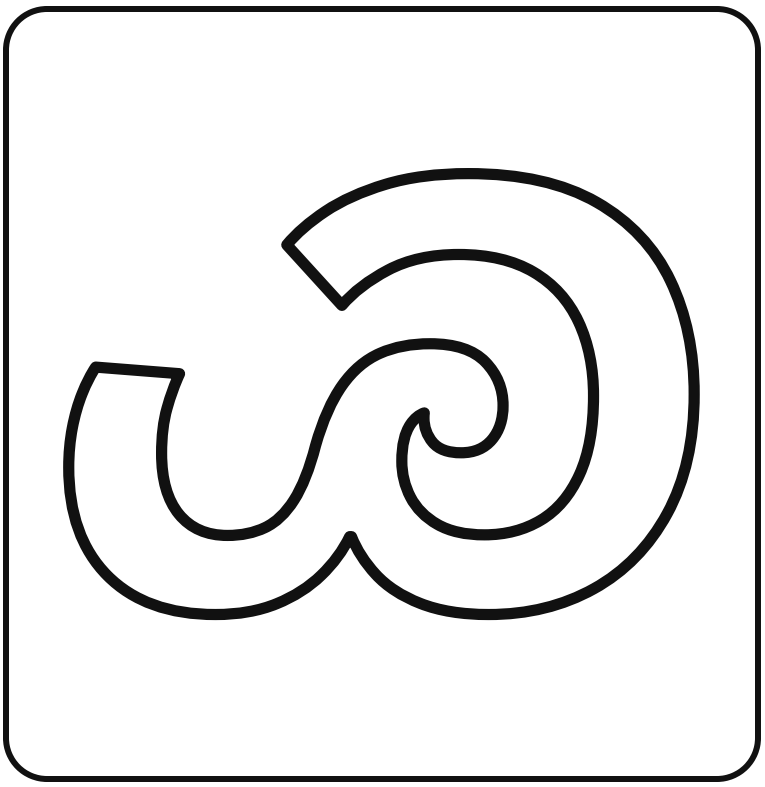
river

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏁ

Ꮙᵓ Ꮙᵓ Ꮙᵓ Ꮙᵓ

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NAME · SVi

Ꭿ

quu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

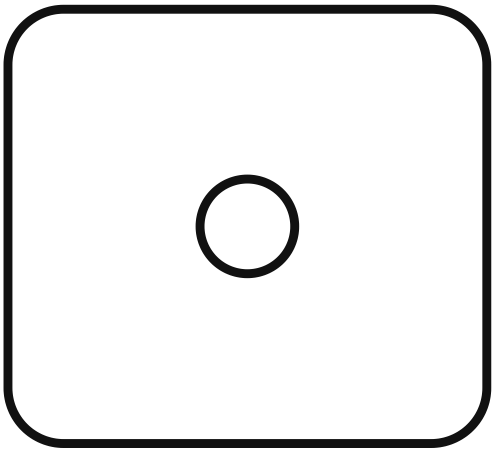
‘gw’ as in “Gwen” (some say ‘kw’ as in “queen”) + ‘oo’ as in “moon” → **gwoo**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮤ	Ꭿ	Ꮼ	Ꮿ	**Ꭿ**	Ᏹ
qua	que	qui	quo	**quu**	quv

The box shows this sign in **the GW (QU) row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Ꭿ are rare, so find Ꭿ **inside** ᏐᏫ (sa-**quu**).



Ꭿ IS FOR

ᏐᏫ

sah-gwoo

one

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · AᎯᎱW

Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ

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Ꭿ

NAME · SVi

Ꭿ

quv

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

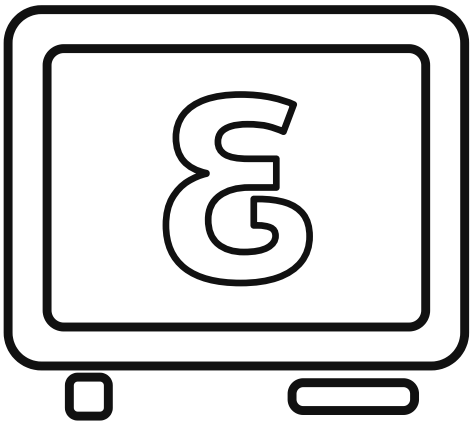
‘gw’ as in “Gwen” (some say ‘kw’ as in “queen”) + ‘uh’ said through the nose, like a humming “uh” → **gwuhn**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭵ	Ꭷ	Ꭹ	Ꭻ	Ꭽ	Ꭿ
qua	que	qui	quo	quu	quv

The box shows this sign in **the GW (QU) row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꭿ IS FOR

Ꭿ

gwuhn

sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ

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S, D and T Ꭴ Ꮾ

sa · da

The **S** row and the **D / T** row.

Ꭴ	Ꮻ	Ꮴ	Ꮾ	Ꮿ	Ᏼ	Ᏽ
sa	*s*	*se*	*si*	*so*	*su*	*sv*

Ꮾ	Ꮼ	Ꮽ	Ꮾ	Ꭻ	Ꭼ	Ꮿ	Ꮽ	Ꮿ
da	*ta*	*de*	*te*	*di*	*ti*	*do*	*du*	*dv*

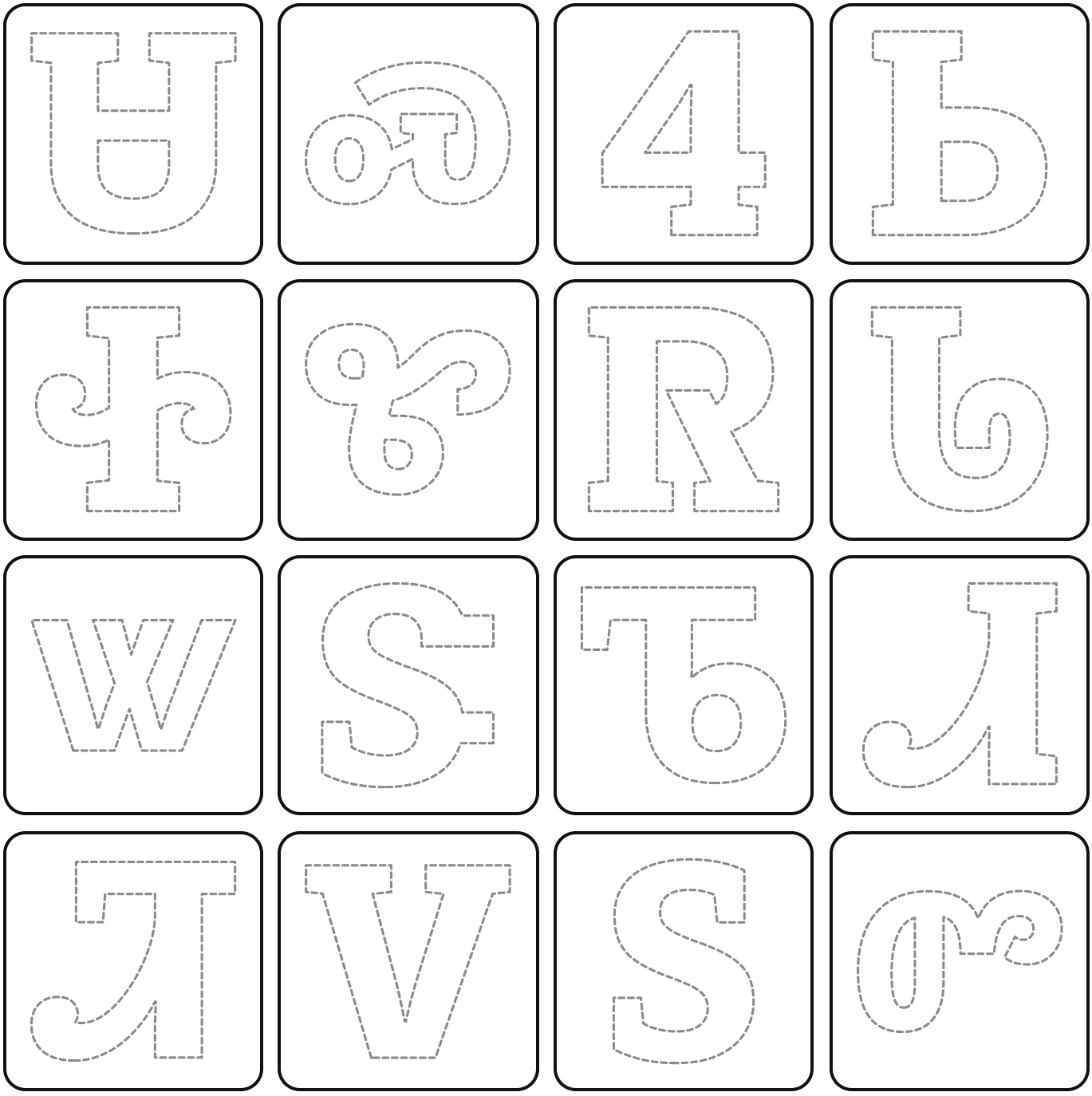
The hissing sign
Ꮻ is just the sound **s**, with no vowel. It joins the next syllable: **Ꮻ + A** = *sgo*, as in ᏍᏫᎯᏂ (ten).

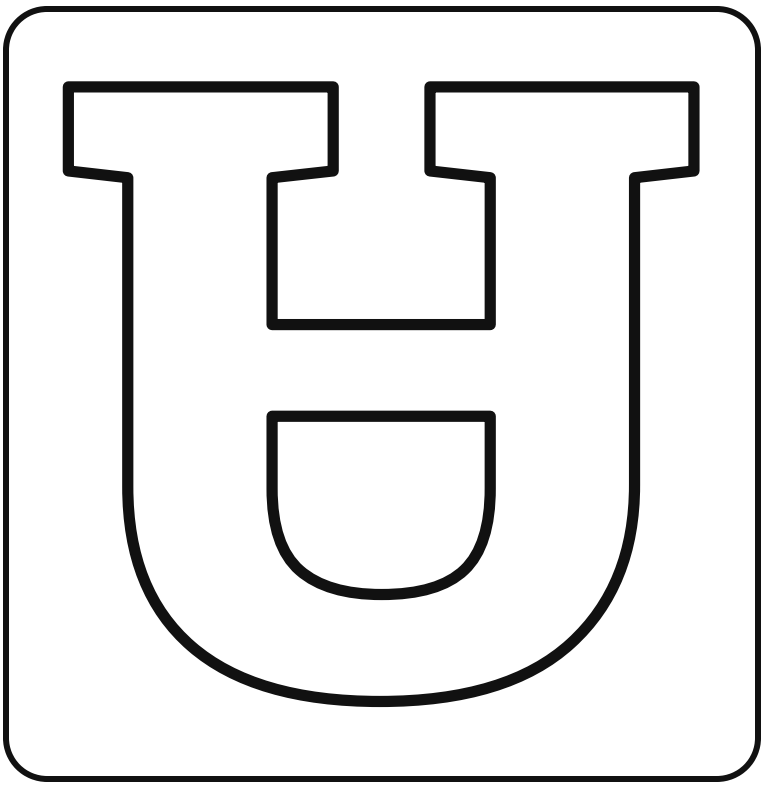
D and T
Some syllables have two signs: **Ꮾ da** and **Ꮼ ta**, **Ꮽ de** and **Ꮾ te**, **Ꭻ di** and **Ꭼ ti**.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace s, d and t Ʊ ƭ

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





NAME · SVi

Ꮥ

sa

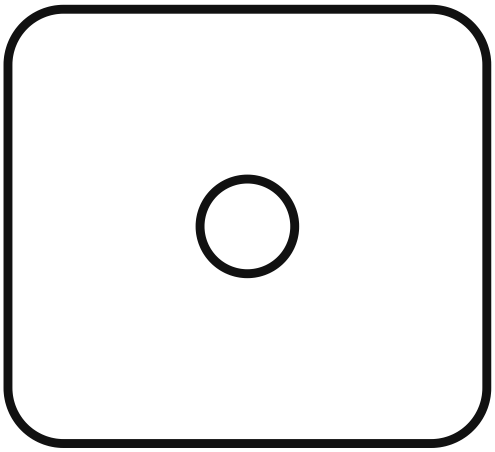
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun” + ‘ah’ as in “father”
→ **sah**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮥ	ᏍᏉ	Ꮞ	Ꮟ	Ꮠ	Ꮡ	Ꮢ
sa	s	se	si	so	su	sv

The box shows this sign in **the S row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꮥ IS FOR

ᏍᏓ

sah-gwoo

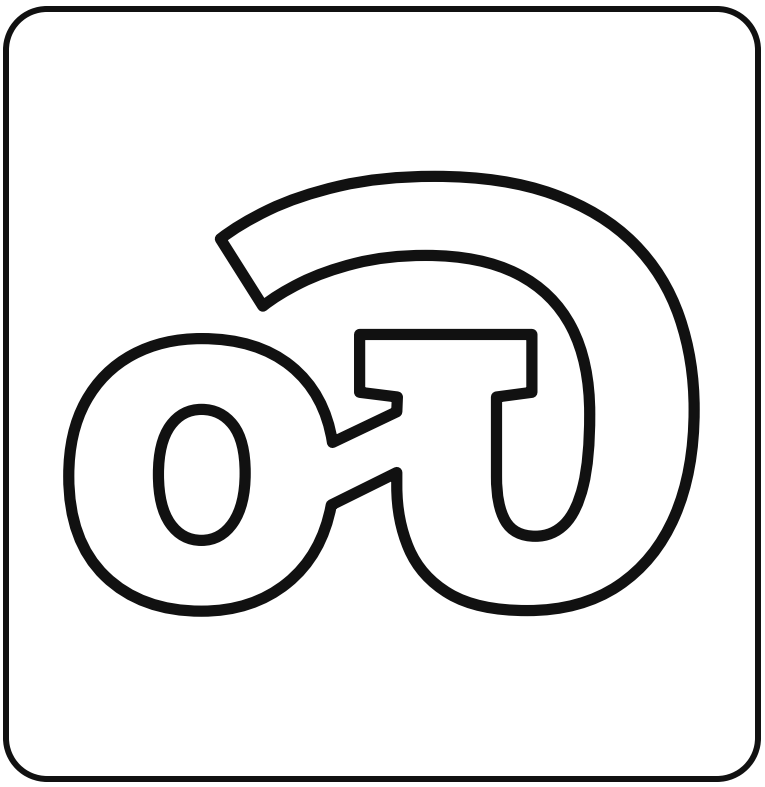
one — count 1 pebble

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎸᎳ

Ꮥ Ꮥ Ꮥ Ꮥ

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NAME · SVi

Ꮥ

s

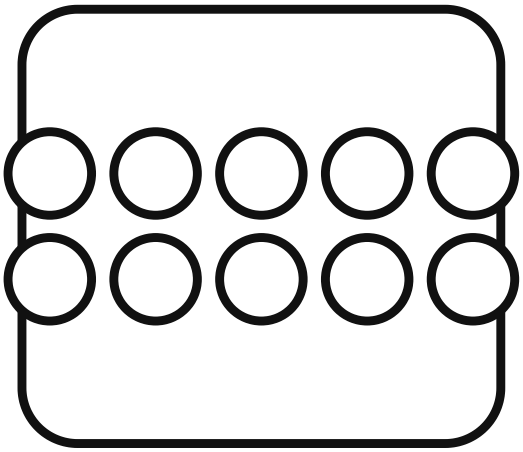
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

just ‘s’, as in “sun” — a hiss with no vowel. It joins onto the next syllable: Ꮥ + A = ‘sgo’.

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭴ	**Ꮥ**	4	Ꮾ	Ꮿ	Ᏼ	Ꭱ
sa	**s**	se	si	so	su	sv

The box shows this sign in **the S row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꮥ IS FOR

ᏍᎪ

sgoh-hee

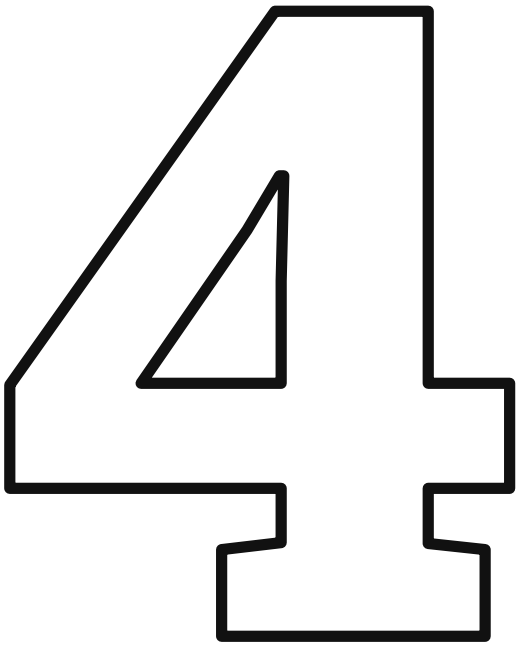
ten — count 10 pebbles

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · AᏯᎳW

Ꮥ Ꮥ Ꮥ Ꮥ

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NAME · SVi

4

se

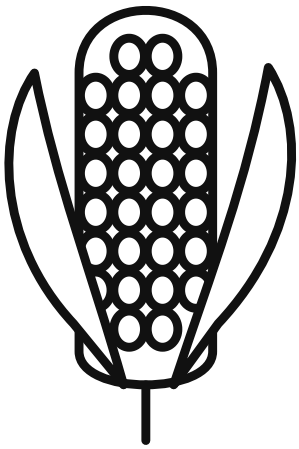
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun” + ‘eh’ as in “bed”
→ **seh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭴ	Ꭶ	4	Ꮾ	Ꮿ	Ᏼ	Ᏽ
sa	s	se	si	so	su	sv

The box shows this sign in **the S row** of the syllabary chart.



4 IS FOR

4M

seh-loo

corn

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

4 4 4 4

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Ь

NAME · SVi

Ь

si

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun” + ‘ee’ as in “see” → **see**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭴ	ᏍᏪ	4	Ь	Ꮥ	Ᏸ	Ꭱ
sa	s	se	si	so	su	sv

The box shows this sign in **the S row** of the syllabary chart.



Ь IS FOR

ЬOᔓᏏ

see-nuhn-dah

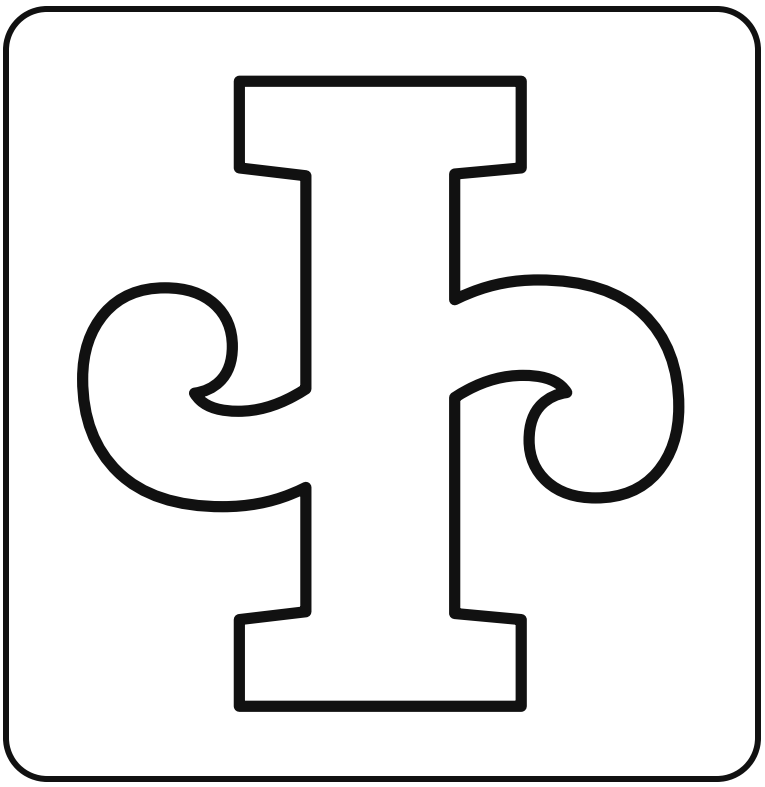
moon, month

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

Ь Ь Ь Ь

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NAME · SVi

Ꮥ

so

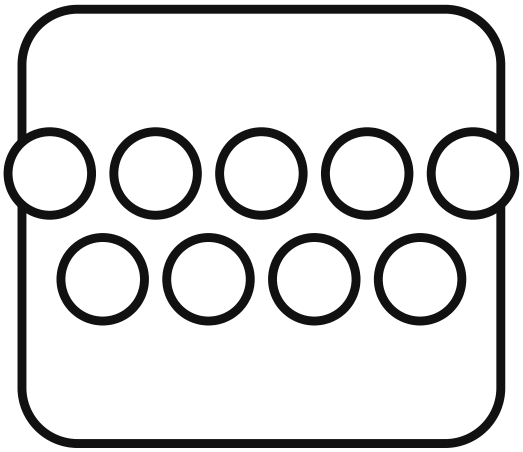
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun” + ‘oh’ as in “go” → **soh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮣ	Ꮤ	Ꮦ	Ꮧ	**Ꮥ**	Ꮨ	Ꮩ
sa	s	se	si	**so**	su	sv

The box shows this sign in **the S row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꮥ IS FOR

ᏥᏁᎳ

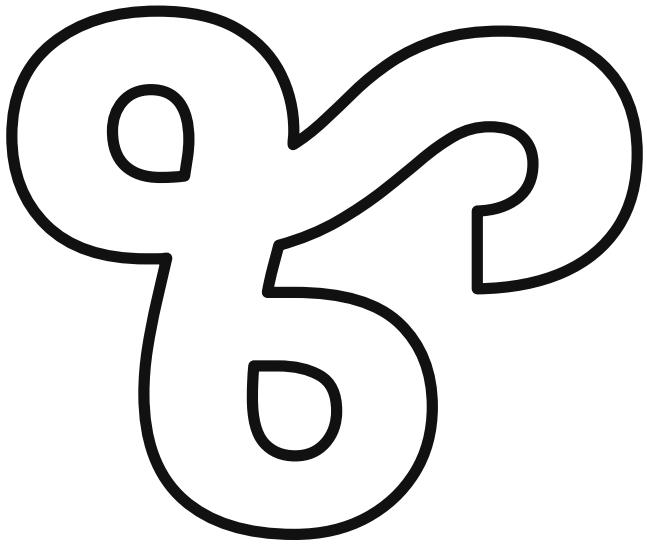
soh-neh-lah

nine — count 9 pebbles

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳ

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NAME · SVi

Ꮥ

su

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

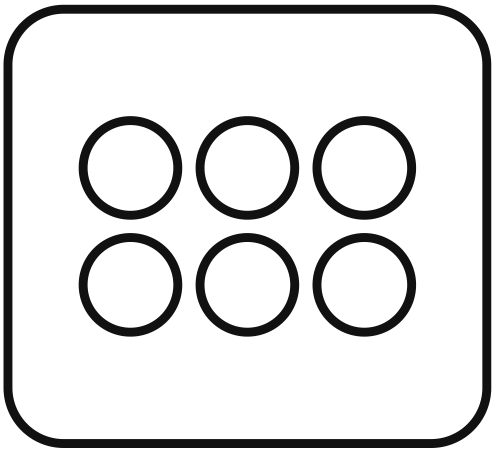
‘s’ as in “sun” + ‘oo’ as in “moon”

→ **SOO**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭶ	Ꭷ	Ꮴ	Ꮾ	Ꮿ	**Ꮥ**	Ᏼ
sa	s	se	si	so	**su**	sv

The box shows this sign in **the S row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꮥ IS FOR

ᏥᏓᏢ

soo-dah-lee

six — count 6 pebbles

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎯᏍᎳ

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Ꭱ

NAME · SVi

Ꭱ

SV

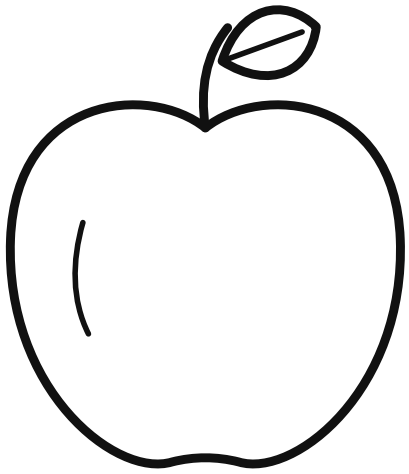
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun” + ‘uh’ said through the nose, like a humming “uh” → **suhn**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭴ	Ꮥ	Ꮞ	Ꮟ	Ꮦ	Ꮧ	Ꭱ
sa	s	se	si	so	su	sv

The box shows this sign in **the S row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꭱ IS FOR

ᏒᏍᏫ

suhn-gah-tah

apple

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏍᏫ

Ꭱ Ꭱ Ꭱ Ꭱ

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Ꮣ

NAME · SVi

Ꮣ

da

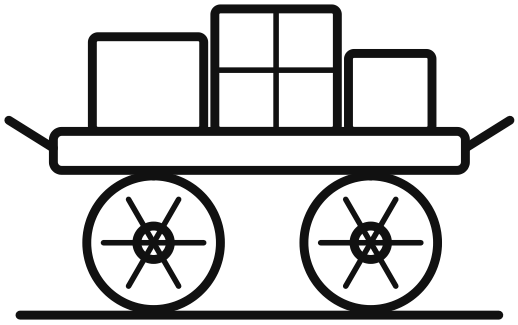
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “dog” + ‘ah’ as in “father” → **dah**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮣ da	Ꮤ ta	Ꮥ de	Ꮦ te	Ꮧ di	Ꮨ ti	Ꮩ do	Ꮪ du	Ꮬ dv

The box shows this sign in **the D / T row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꮣ IS FOR

ᏣᎢᏧᎷ

dah-gwah-leh-loo

wagon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · AᏯᏪW

Ꮣ Ꮣ Ꮣ Ꮣ

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NAME · SVi

Ꮤ

ta

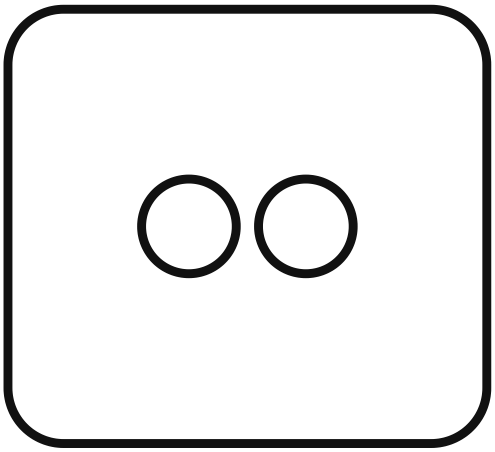
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “top” + ‘ah’ as in “father”
→ **tah**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮾ	**Ꮤ**	Ꮿ	Ꮐ	Ꮑ	Ꮒ	Ꮓ	Ꮔ	Ꮕ
da	**ta**	de	te	di	ti	do	du	dv

The box shows this sign in **the D / T row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꮤ IS FOR

Ꮤᑭ

tah-lee

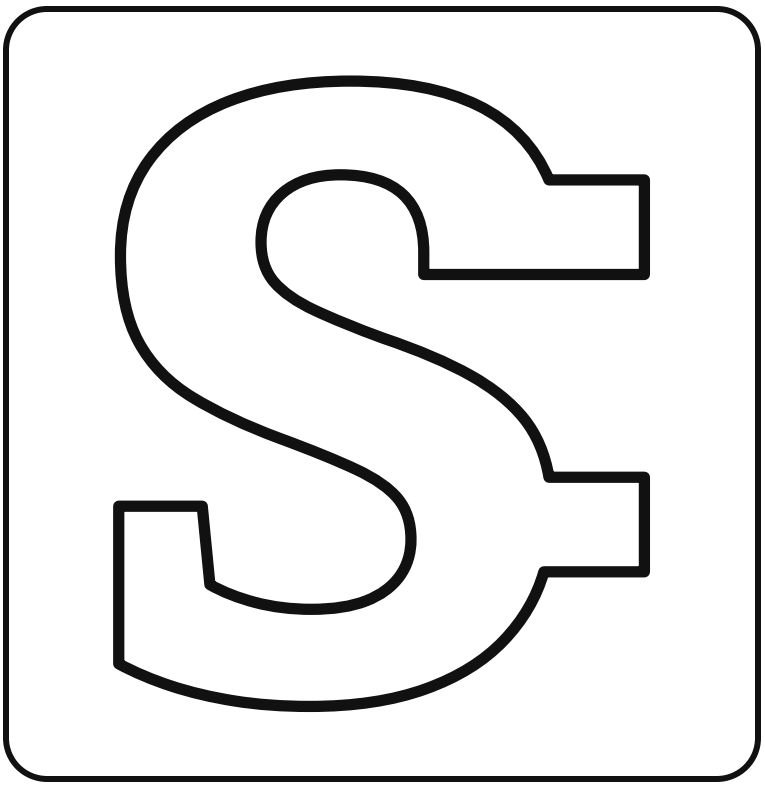
two — count 2 pebbles

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · AᏯᏩW

Ꮤ Ꮤ Ꮤ Ꮤ

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NAME · SVi

Ꮣ

de

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “dog” + ‘eh’ as in “bed”
→ **deh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮄ	Ꮃ	**Ꮣ**	Ꭶ	Ꭻ	Ꭽ	Ꮩ	Ꮥ	Ꮆ
da	ta	**de**	te	di	ti	do	du	dv

The box shows this sign in **the D / T row** of the syllabary chart.

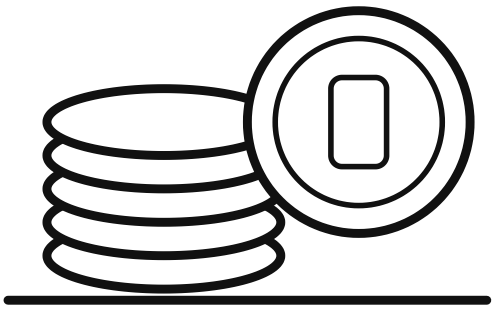
Words starting with Ꮣ are rare, so find Ꮣ **inside** ᎠᏕᎳ (a-**de**-la).

Ꮣ IS FOR

ᎠᏕᎳ

ah-deh-lah

money, coins

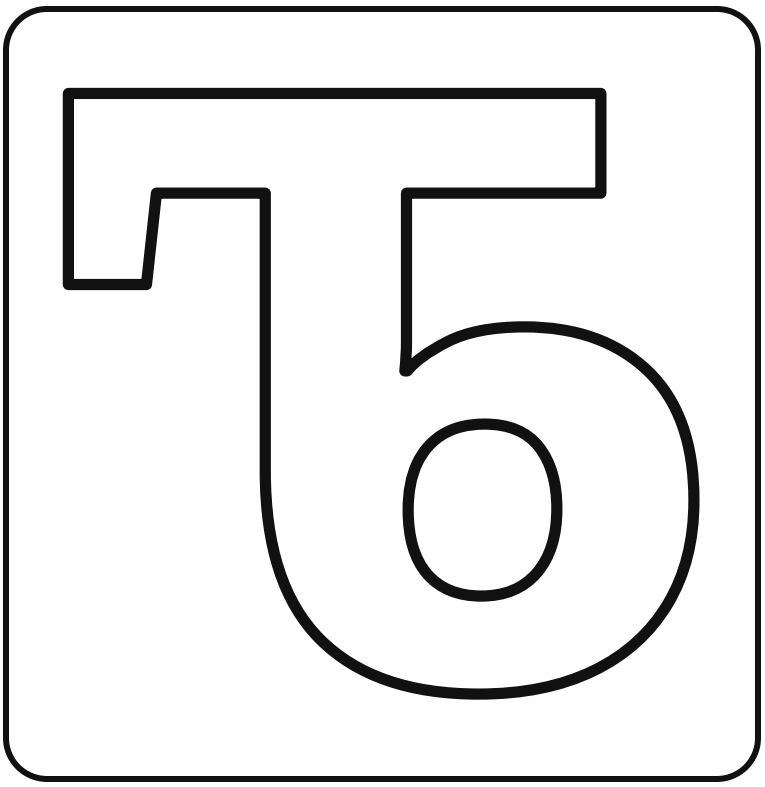


Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳ

Ꮣ Ꮣ Ꮣ Ꮣ

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NAME · SVi

Ꭲ

te

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “top” + ‘eh’ as in “bed” → **teh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮄ	Ꮵ	Ꮉ	**Ꭲ**	Ꭹ	Ꭻ	Ꮩ	Ꮥ	Ꮶ
da	ta	de	**te**	di	ti	do	du	dv

The box shows this sign in **the D / T row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꭲ IS FOR

Ꭲ

teh

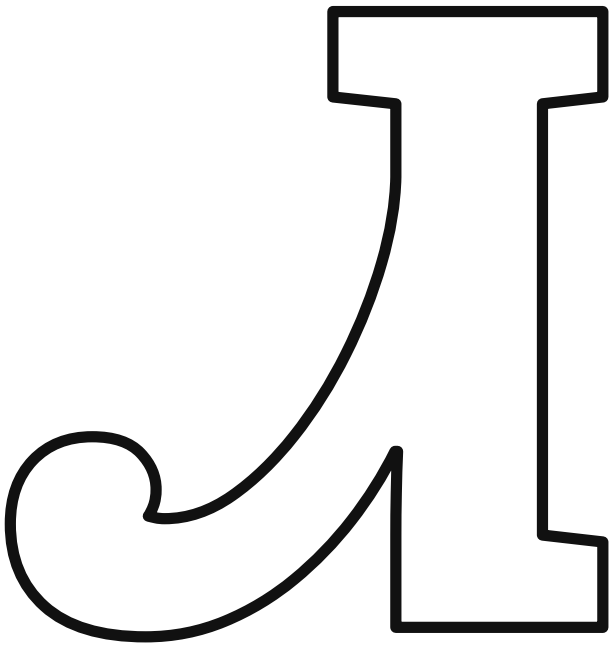
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

Ꭲ Ꭲ Ꭲ Ꭲ

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NAME · SVi

Ꭻ

di

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

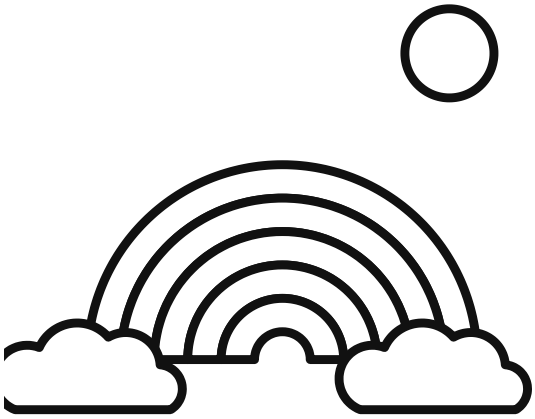
‘d’ as in “dog” + ‘ee’ as in “see” → **dee**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮄ	Ꮵ	Ꮥ	Ꮦ	**Ꭻ**	Ꭿ	Ꮙ	Ꮪ	Ꮷ
da	ta	de	te	**di**	ti	do	du	dv

The box shows this sign in **the D / T row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Ꭻ are rare, so find Ꭻ **inside** ᏕᎩᏅᏆ (ga-lv-la-**di**).



Ꭻ IS FOR

ᏕᎩᏅᏆ

gah-luhn-lah-dee

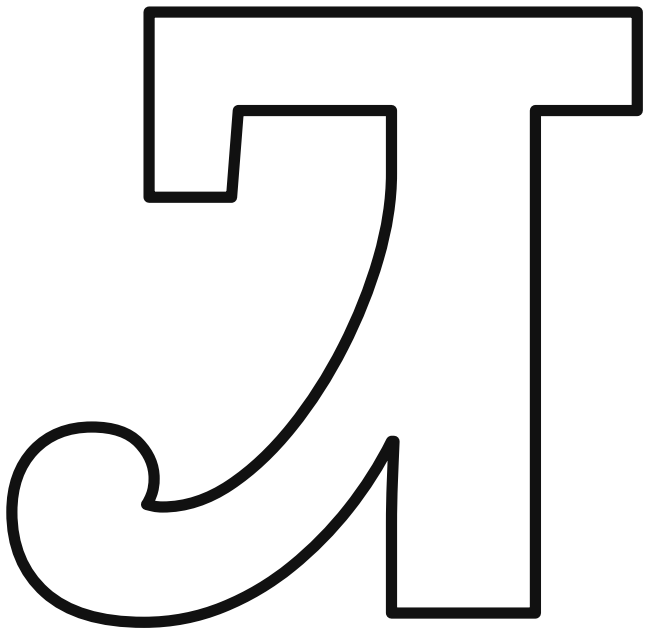
sky, up above

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏰᎳ

Ꭻ Ꭻ Ꭻ Ꭻ

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NAME · SVi

Ꭲ

ti

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

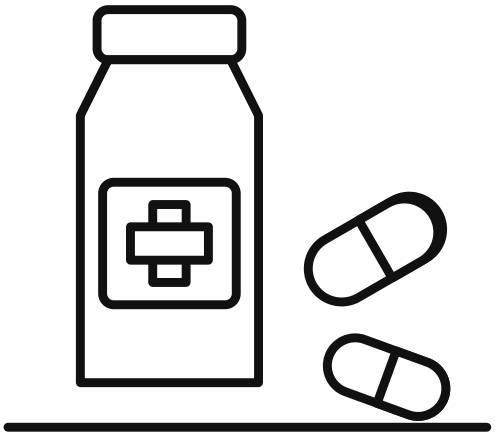
‘t’ as in “top” + ‘ee’ as in “see” → **tee**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮄ	Ꮵ	Ꮼ	Ꮽ	Ꭵ	**Ꭲ**	Ꮿ	Ꮾ	Ᏽ
da	ta	de	te	di	**ti**	do	du	dv

The box shows this sign in **the D / T row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Ꭲ are rare, so find Ꭲ **inside** Ꭴ-Ꮷ**Ꭲ** (nv-wo-**ti**).



Ꭲ IS FOR

Ꭴ-Ꮷ**Ꭲ**

nuhn-woh-tee

medicine

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳ

Ꭲ Ꭲ Ꭲ Ꭲ

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Ꭵ

NAME · SVi

Ꭵ

do

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “dog” + ‘oh’ as in “go” → **doh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮄ	Ꮵ	Ꮉ	Ꮖ	Ꭻ	Ꭿ	Ꭵ	Ꮥ	Ꮷ
da	ta	de	te	di	ti	do	du	dv

The box shows this sign in **the D / T row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꭵ IS FOR

ᏙᏍ

doh-hee

peace, calm

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏰᎳ

Ꭵ Ꭵ Ꭵ Ꭵ

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Ꮥ

NAME · ᏚᏙi

Ꮥ

du

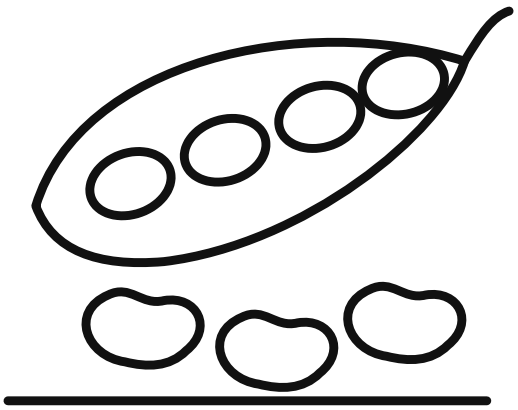
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “dog” + ‘oo’ as in “moon”
→ **doo**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮄ	Ꮵ	Ꮣ	Ꮖ	Ꭻ	Ꭽ	Ꮩ	Ꮥ	Ꮶ
da	ta	de	te	di	ti	do	du	dv

The box shows this sign in **the D / T row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꮥ IS FOR

ᏕᏯ

doo-yah

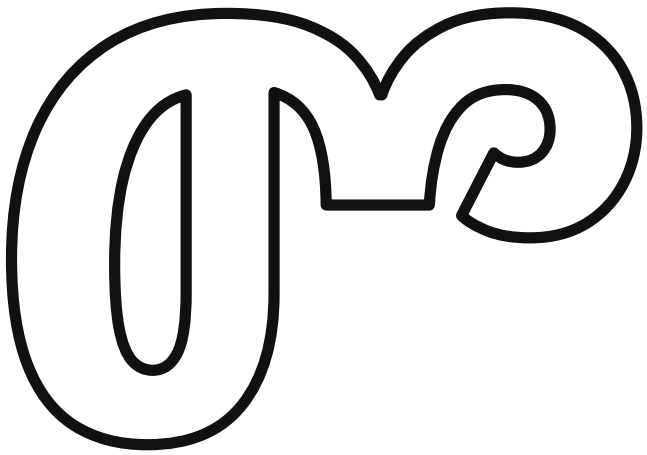
beans

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

Ꮥ Ꮥ Ꮥ Ꮥ

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NAME · SVi

Ꭰᵛ

dv

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

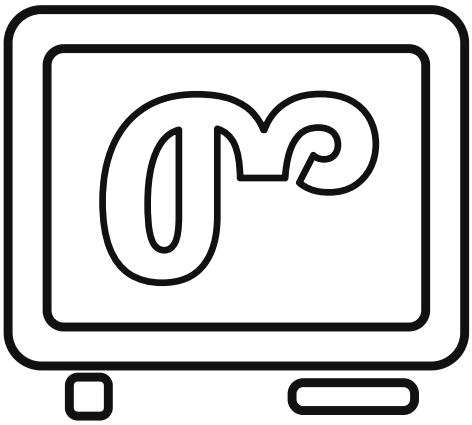
‘d’ as in “dog” + ‘uh’ said through the nose, like a humming “uh” → **duhn**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮄ	Ꮵ	Ꮥ	Ꮶ	Ꭵ	Ꭻ	Ꮙ	Ꮪ	Ꭰᵛ
da	ta	de	te	di	ti	do	du	dv

The box shows this sign in **the D / T row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꭰᵛ IS FOR

Ꭰᵛ

duhn

sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

Ꭰᵛ Ꭰᵛ Ꭰᵛ Ꭰᵛ

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TL, J, W and Y ꭶ Ꮯ Ꮆ ꮻ

dla · tsa · wa · ya

The last four rows. **Well done — you are nearly at the end of the chart!**

ꭶ *dla*	Ꮮ *tla*	Ꮮ *tle*	Ꮯ *tli*	Ꮹ *tlo*	Ꮿ *tlu*	Ᏻ *tlv*
Ꮯ *tsa*	Ꮼ *tse*	Ꮾ *tsi*	Ꮿ *tso*	Ꮽ *tsu*	Ꮿ *tsv*	
Ꮆ *wa*	Ꮇ *we*	Ꮈ *wi*	Ꮎ *wo*	Ꮑ *wu*	Ꮖ *wv*	
ꮻ *ya*	Ꮄ *ye*	Ꮅ *yi*	Ꮋ *yo*	Ᏽ *yu*	Ᏼ *yv*	

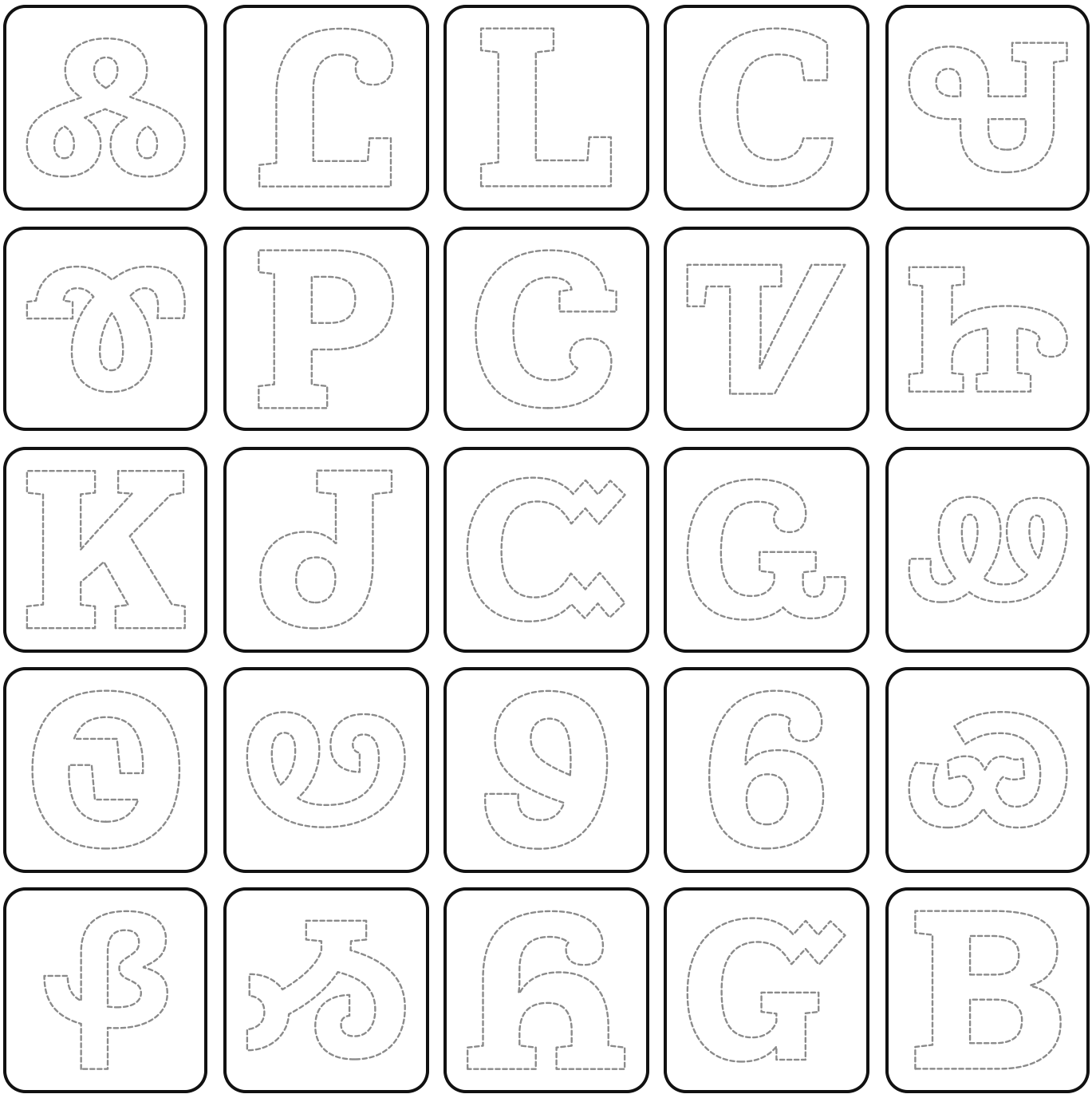
TL and J

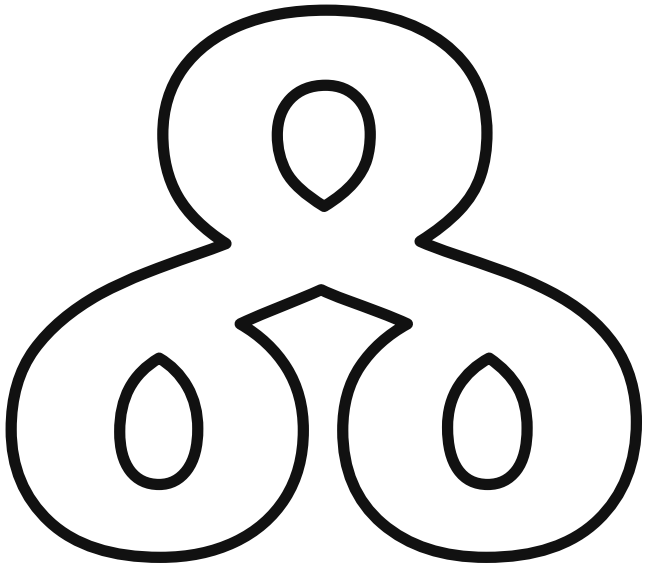
tl is a ‘t’ that slides into ‘l’. The **ts** row is said like ‘j’ in many homes: **ᏣᎳᎩ** (Cherokee) sounds like *jah-lah-gee*.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace tl, j, w and y ꠸ ꠇ ꠎ ꠲

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





NAME · SVi

Ꭰ

dla

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

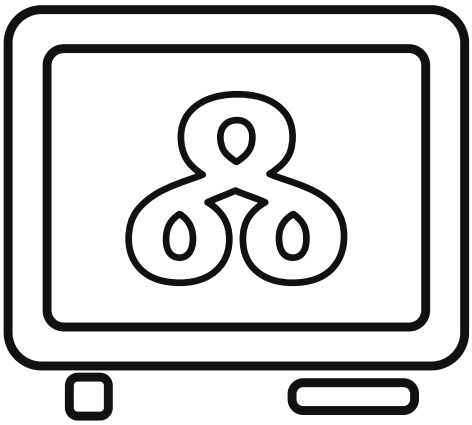
‘dl’ — a soft ‘d’ that slides into ‘l’ + ‘ah’ as in “father” → **dlah**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭰ	Ꮭ	Ꮮ	Ꮯ	Ꮹ	Ꮾ	Ᏻ
dla	tla	tle	tli	tlo	tlu	tlv

The box shows this sign in **the DL / TL row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꭰ IS FOR

Ꭰ

dlah

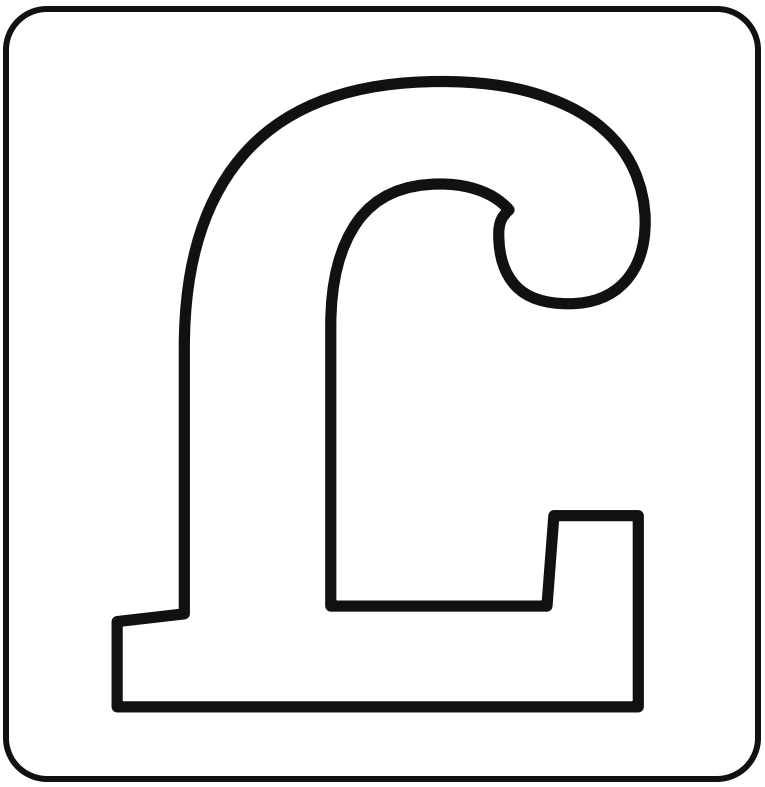
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏰᎳ

Ꭰ Ꭰ Ꭰ Ꭰ

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NAME · SVi

Ꮮ

tla

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

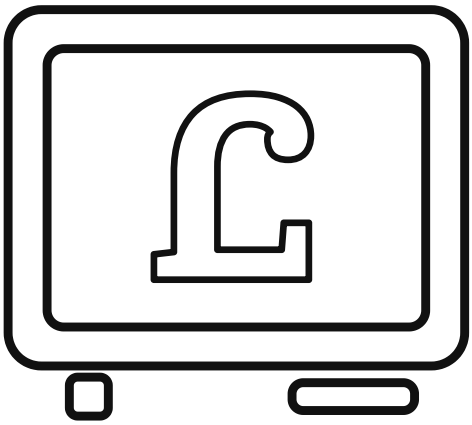
‘tl’ — a ‘t’ that slides into ‘l’, with air at the sides of the tongue + ‘ah’ as in “father” → **tlah**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

ᘐ	Ꮮ	L	C	Ꮼ	Ꮾ	P
dla	tla	tle	tli	tlo	tlu	tlv

The box shows this sign in **the DL / TL row** of the syllabary chart.

Ꮮ on its own is a whole word: “no”. Ꮮ also starts many “not” words.



Ꮮ IS FOR

Ꮮ

tlah

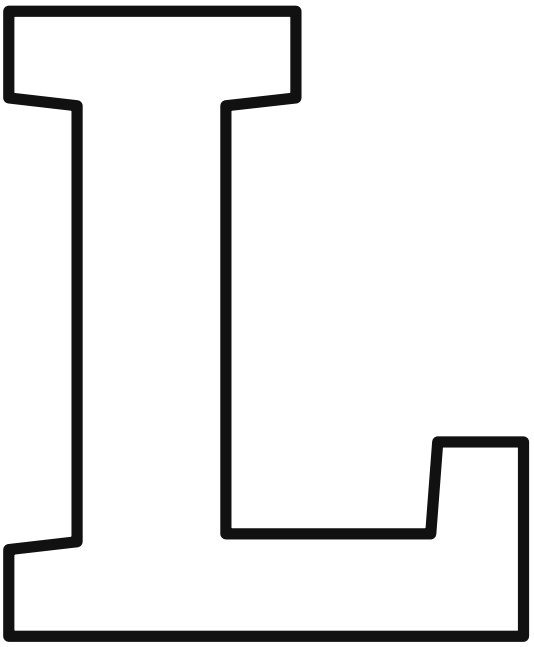
no!

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

Ꮮ Ꮮ Ꮮ Ꮮ

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NAME · SVi

L

tle

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

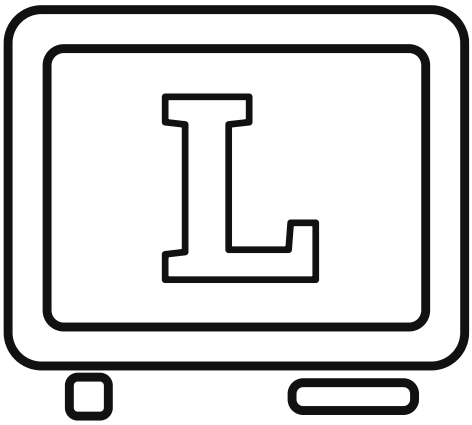
'tl' — a 't' that slides into 'l', with air at the sides of the tongue + 'eh' as in "bed" → **tleh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭰ	Ꮮ	**Ꮮ**	Ꮯ	Ꮹ	Ꮾ	Ᏼ
dla	tla	**tle**	tli	tlo	tlu	tlv

The box shows this sign in **the DL / TL row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



L IS FOR

L

tleh

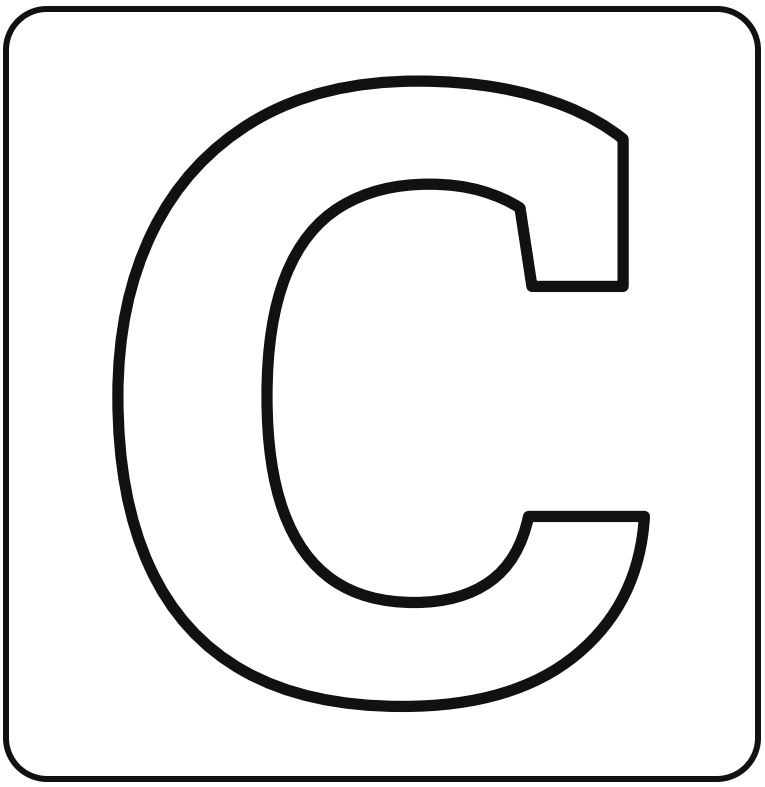
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏍᎩᏔ

L L L L

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NAME · SVi

C

tli

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

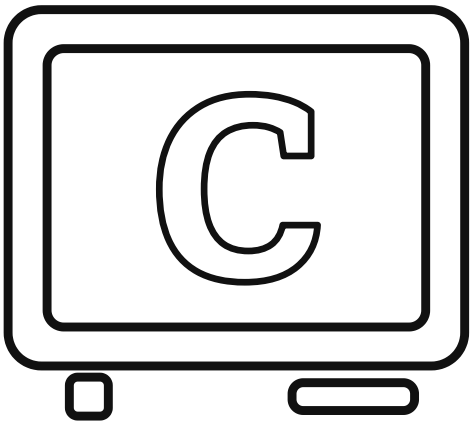
‘tl’ — a ‘t’ that slides into ‘l’, with air at the sides of the tongue + ‘ee’ as in “see” → **tlee**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭰ	Ꮭ	Ꮮ	**Ꮯ**	Ꮹ	Ꮿ	Ᏼ
dla	tla	tle	**tli**	tlo	tlu	tlv

The box shows this sign in **the DL / TL row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



C IS FOR

C

tlee

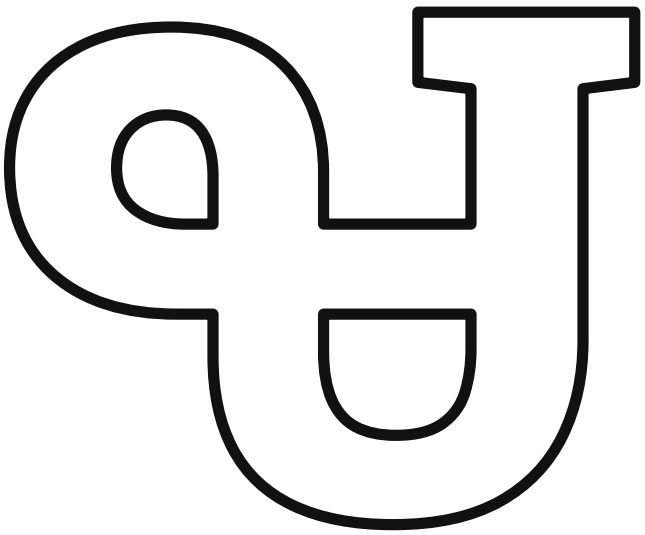
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏍᎩᏔ

C C C C

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NAME · SVi

Ꮼ

tlo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

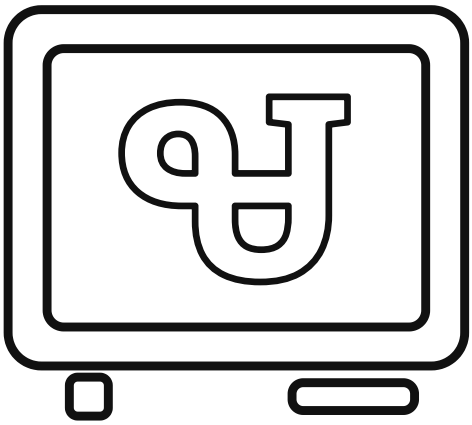
‘tl’ — a ‘t’ that slides into ‘l’, with air at the sides of the tongue + ‘oh’ as in “go” → **tloh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

ᏚᎸ	ᏝᎸ	ᏞᎸ	ᏟᎸ	**ᏬᎸ**	ᏭᎸ	ᏢᎸ
dla	tla	tle	tli	**tlo**	tlu	tlv

The box shows this sign in **the DL / TL row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꮼ IS FOR

Ꮼ

tloh

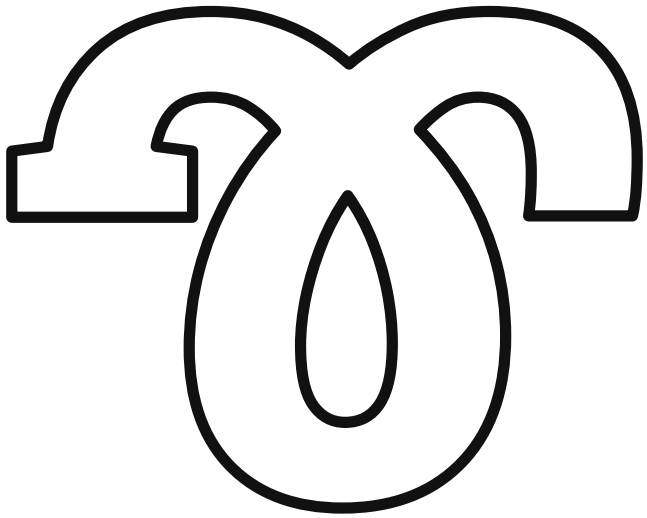
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

Ꮼ Ꮼ Ꮼ Ꮼ

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NAME · SVi

Ꮤ

tlu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

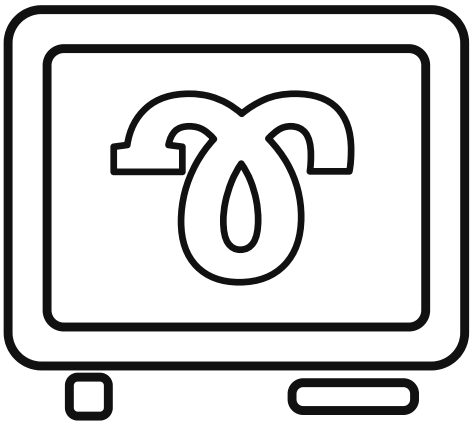
‘tl’ — a ‘t’ that slides into ‘l’, with air at the sides of the tongue + ‘oo’ as in “moon” → **tloo**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

ꭶ	Ꮭ	Ꮮ	Ꮯ	Ꮹ	**Ꮼ**	Ꮿ
dla	tla	tle	tli	tlo	**tlu**	tlv

The box shows this sign in **the DL / TL row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꮼ IS FOR

Ꮼ

tloo

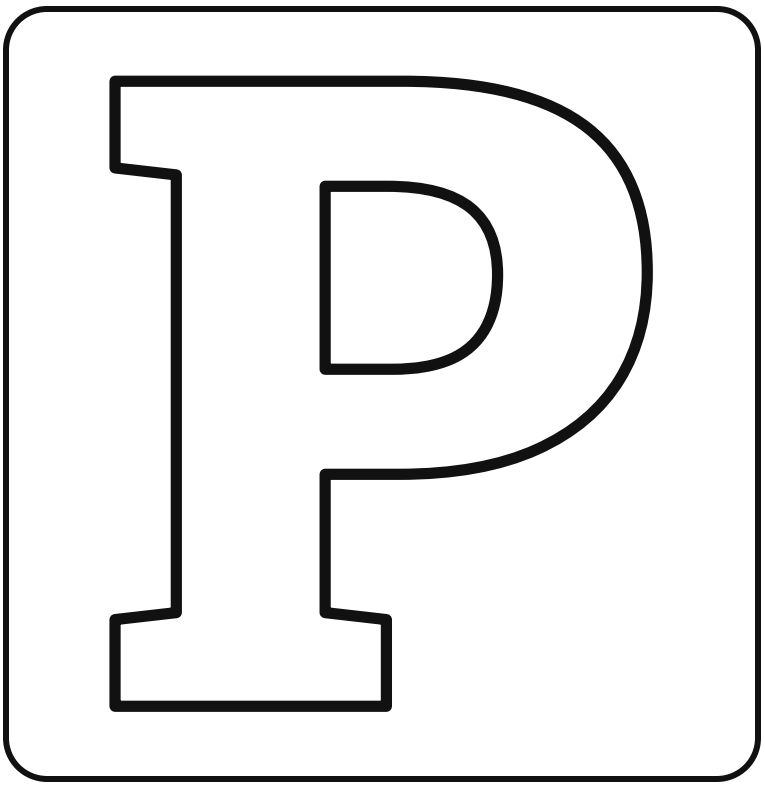
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

Ꮼ Ꮼ Ꮼ Ꮼ

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NAME · SVi

P

tlv

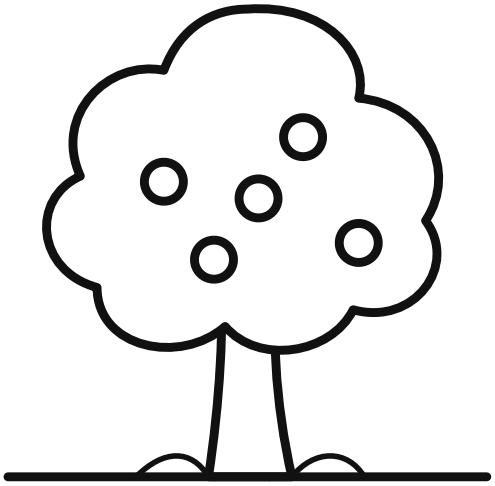
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'tl' — a 't' that slides into 'l', with air at the sides of the tongue + 'uh' said through the nose, like a humming "uh" → **tluhn**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮄ	Ꮅ	L	C	Ꮊ	Ꮎ	P
dla	tla	tle	tli	tlo	tlu	tlv

The box shows this sign in **the DL / TL row** of the syllabary chart.



P IS FOR

PE

tluhn-guhn

tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎯᏍᎩᎳ

P P P P

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Ꮯ

NAME · SVi

Ꮯ

tsa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'j' as in "jam" (some families say 'ts' as in "cats") + 'ah' as in "father" → **jah**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮯ	Ꮿ	Ꮀ	Ꮁ	Ꮂ	Ꮃ
tsa	tse	tsi	tso	tsu	tsv

The box shows this sign in **the J (TS) row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꮯ IS FOR

Ꮯwy

jah-lah-gee

Cherokee — the people and their language

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏍᎩᏔ

Ꮯ Ꮯ Ꮯ Ꮯ

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Ꭿ

NAME · SVi

Ꭿ

tse

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

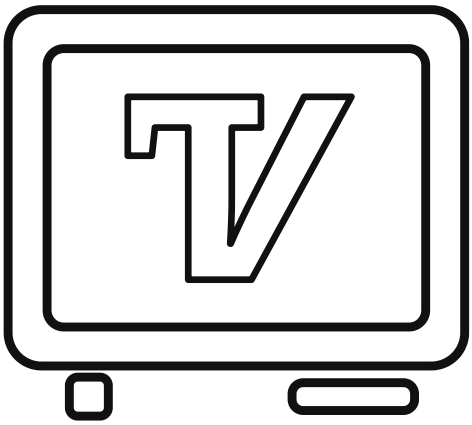
‘j’ as in “jam” (some families say ‘ts’ as in “cats”) + ‘eh’ as in “bed” → **jeh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮳ	Ꭿ	Ꮄ	Ꮶ	Ꮷ	Ꮼ
tsa	tse	tsi	tso	tsu	tsv

The box shows this sign in **the J (TS) row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꭿ IS FOR

Ꭿ

jeh

sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎸᎳ

Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ Ꭿ

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Ꮰ

NAME · SVi

Ꮰ

tsi

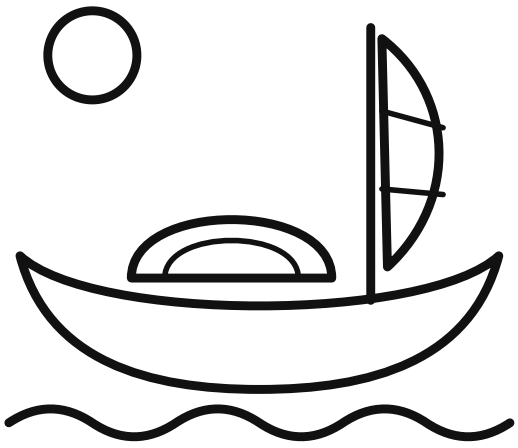
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘j’ as in “jam” (some families say ‘ts’ as in “cats”) + ‘ee’ as in “see” → **jee**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮳ	Ꮴ	**Ꮰ**	Ꮵ	Ꮶ	Ꮷ
tsa	tse	**tsi**	tso	tsu	tsv

The box shows this sign in **the J (TS) row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꮰ IS FOR

ᏥᎶ

jee-yoo

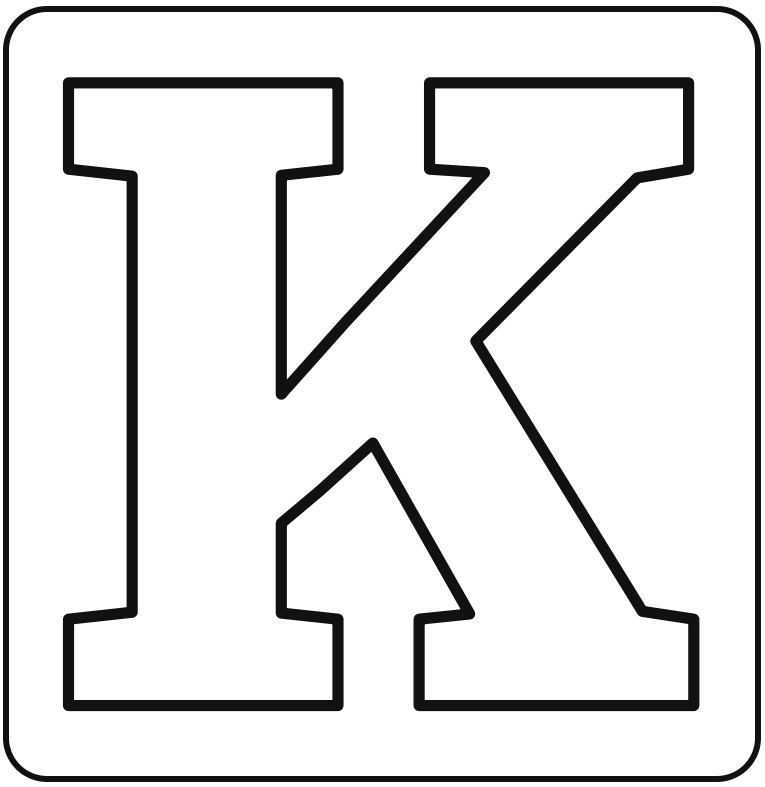
boat, canoe

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

Ꮰ Ꮰ Ꮰ Ꮰ

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NAME · SVi

K

tso

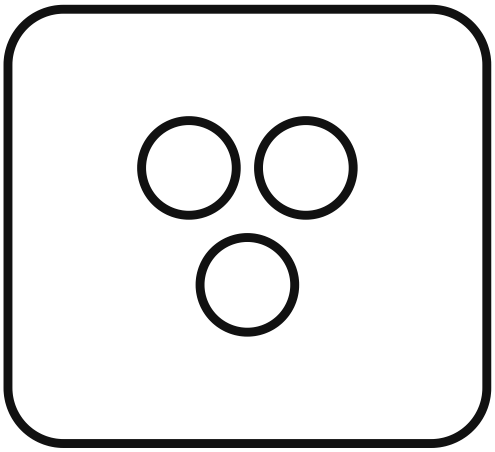
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘j’ as in “jam” (some families say ‘ts’ as in “cats”) + ‘oh’ as in “go” → **joh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮳ	Ꮴ	Ꮵ	**Ꮶ**	Ꮷ	Ꮸ
tsa	tse	tsi	tso	tsu	tsv

The box shows this sign in **the J (TS) row** of the syllabary chart.



K IS FOR

KT

joh-ee

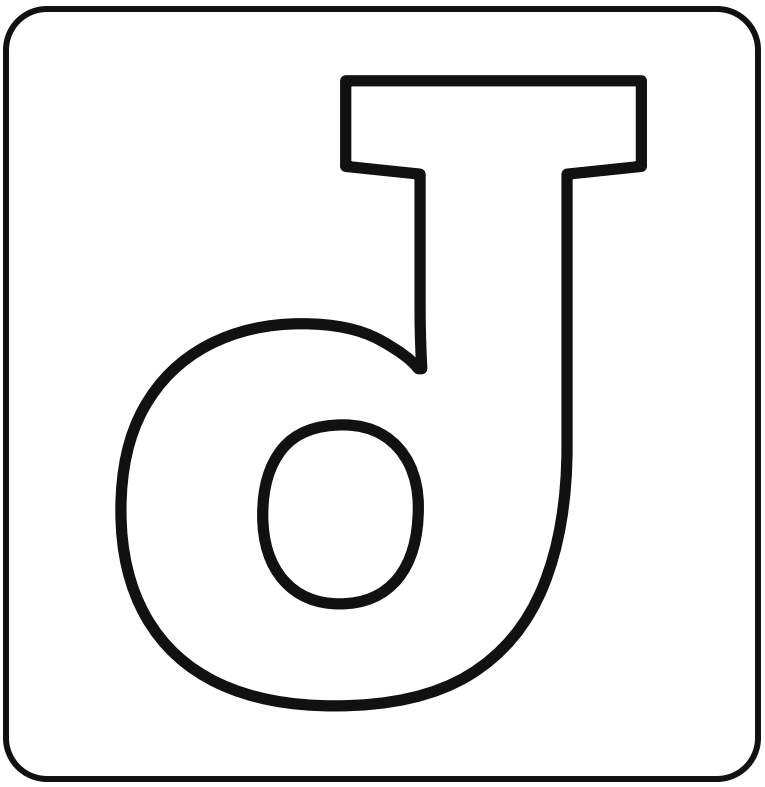
three — count 3 pebbles

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏰᎳ

K K K K

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NAME · SVi

Ꭻ

tsu

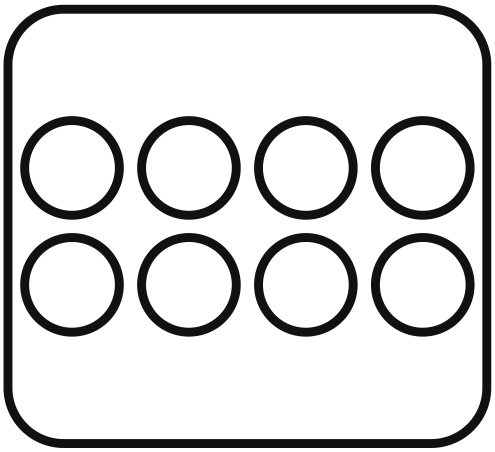
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘j’ as in “jam” (some families say ‘ts’ as in “cats”) + ‘oo’ as in “moon” → **joo**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮳ	Ꮴ	Ꮵ	Ꮶ	**Ꭻ**	Ꮷ
tsa	tse	tsi	tso	**tsu**	tsv

The box shows this sign in **the J (TS) row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꭻ IS FOR

ᎫᏁᎳ

joo-neh-lah

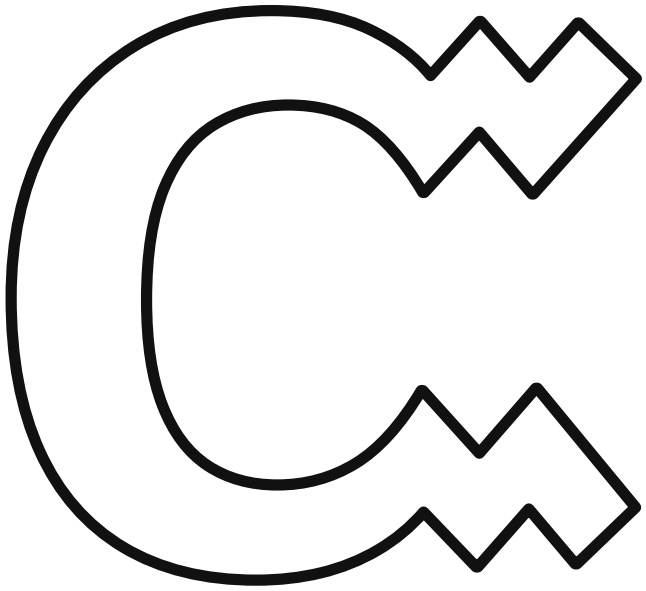
eight — count 8 pebbles

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳ

Ꭻ Ꭻ Ꭻ Ꭻ

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NAME · SVi

Ꮯ

tsv

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

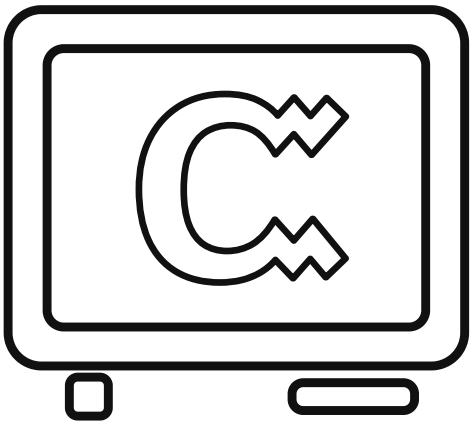
‘j’ as in “jam” (some families say ‘ts’ as in “cats”) + ‘uh’ said through the nose, like a humming “uh” → **juhn**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮳ	Ꮴ	Ꮵ	Ꮶ	Ꮷ	Ꮯ
tsa	tse	tsi	tso	tsu	tsv

The box shows this sign in **the J (TS) row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꮯ IS FOR

Ꮯ

juhn

sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏰᎳ

Ꮯ Ꮯ Ꮯ Ꮯ

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Ꮶ

NAME · SVi

Ꮶ

wa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘w’ as in “water” + ‘ah’ as in “father” → **wah**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮶ wa	Ꮻ we	Ꮼ wi	Ꮽ wo	Ꮾ wu	Ꮿ wv

The box shows this sign in **the W row** of the syllabary chart.



Ꮶ IS FOR

ᏩᏙ

wah-doh

thank you!

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎯᏊᎳ

Ꮶ Ꮶ Ꮶ Ꮶ

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Ꮙ

NAME · SVi

Ꮙ

we

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

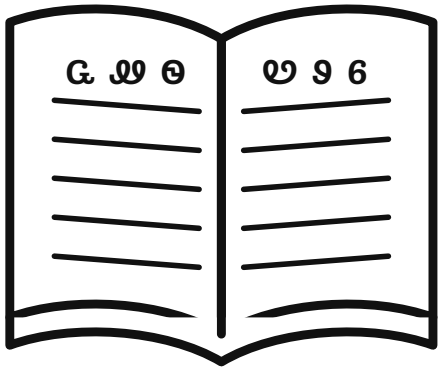
‘w’ as in “water” + ‘eh’ as in “bed” → **weh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭶ	**Ꮙ**	Ꮎ	Ꮩ	Ꮹ	Ꮶ
wa	**we**	wi	wo	wu	wv

The box shows this sign in **the W row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Ꮙ are rare, so find Ꮙ **inside** ᎠᏩᏢ (go-**we**-li).



Ꮙ IS FOR

ᎠᏩᏢ

goh-weh-lee

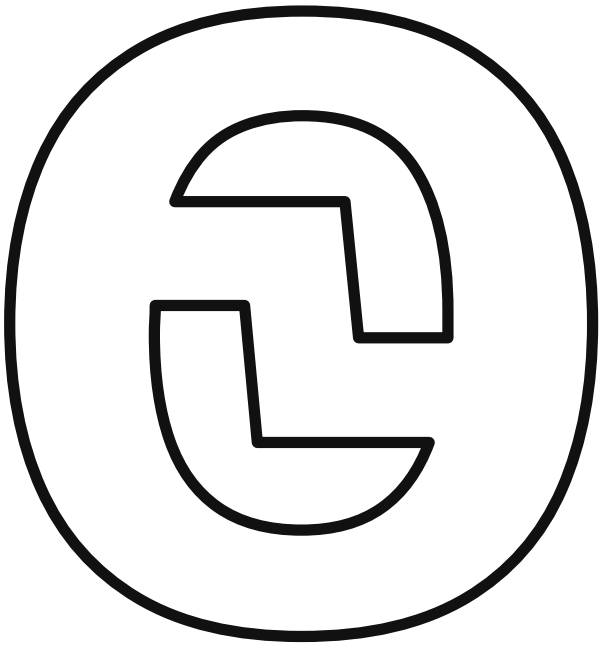
paper, a book, a letter

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏩᎳ

Ꮙ Ꮙ Ꮙ Ꮙ

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NAME · SVi

Ꮙ

wi

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

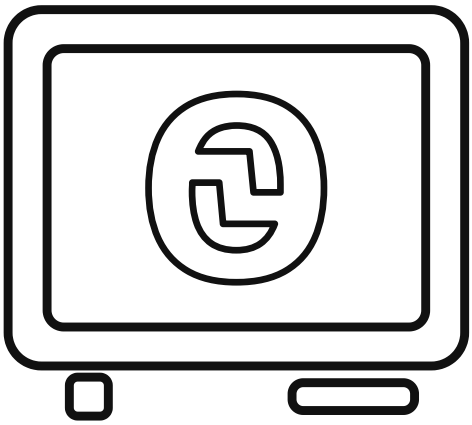
‘w’ as in “water” + ‘ee’ as in “see” → **wee**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭶ	Ꮗ	Ꮙ	Ꮟ	Ꮹ	Ꮶ
wa	we	wi	wo	wu	wv

The box shows this sign in **the W row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꮙ IS FOR

Ꮙ

wee

sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏗᎳ

Ꮙ Ꮙ Ꮙ Ꮙ

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Ꮺ

NAME · SVi

Ꮺ

wo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

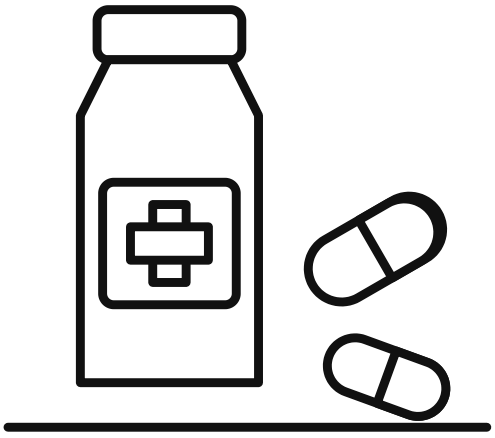
‘w’ as in “water” + ‘oh’ as in “go” → **woh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭶ	Ꮻ	Ꮎ	**Ꮺ**	Ꮹ	Ꮆ
wa	we	wi	**wo**	wu	wv

The box shows this sign in **the W row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Ꮺ are rare, so find Ꮺ **inside** Ꭴ~Ꮺꭻ (nv-**wo**-ti).



Ꮺ IS FOR

Ꭴ~Ꮺꭻ

nuhn-woh-tee

medicine

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · AᏯW

Ꮺ Ꮺ Ꮺ Ꮺ

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Ꮹ

NAME · ᏚᏙᎥ

Ꮹ

wu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

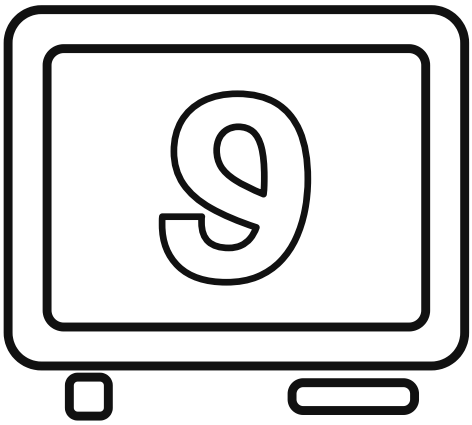
‘w’ as in “water” + ‘oo’ as in “moon” → **woo**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭶ	Ꮻ	Ꮾ	Ꮿ	**Ꮹ**	Ᏸ
wa	we	wi	wo	**wu**	wv

The box shows this sign in **the W row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꮹ IS FOR

Ꮹ

woo

sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎯᏭᏔ

Ꮹ Ꮹ Ꮹ Ꮹ

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NAME · SVi

6

wv

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'w' as in "water" + 'uh' said through the nose, like a humming "uh" → **wuhn**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭶ	Ꭿ	Ꮎ	Ꮑ	Ꮙ	6
wa	we	wi	wo	wu	wv

The box shows this sign in **the W row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



6 IS FOR

6

wuhn

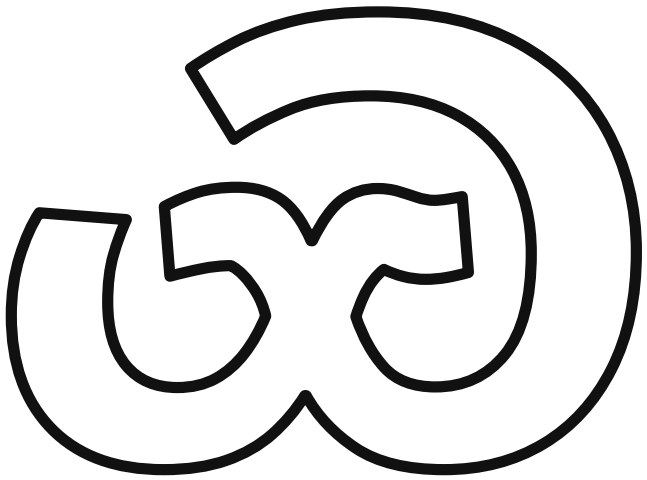
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎯᏧᎳ

6 6 6 6

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NAME · SVi

Ꮻ

ya

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

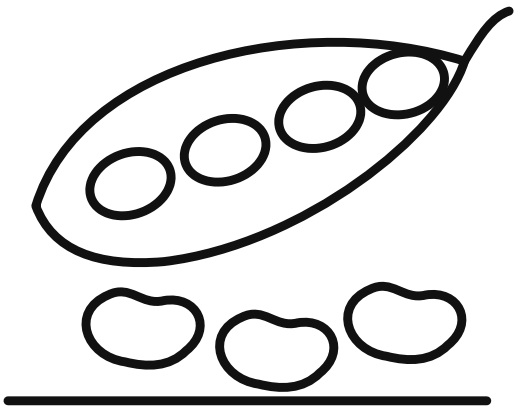
‘y’ as in “yes” + ‘ah’ as in “father” → **yah**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꮻ	Ꮼ	Ꮽ	Ꮾ	Ꮿ	Ᏸ
ya	ye	yi	yo	yu	yv

The box shows this sign in **the Y row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Ꮻ are rare, so find Ꮻ **inside** SᏬ (du-**ya**).



Ꮻ IS FOR

SᏬ

doo-yah

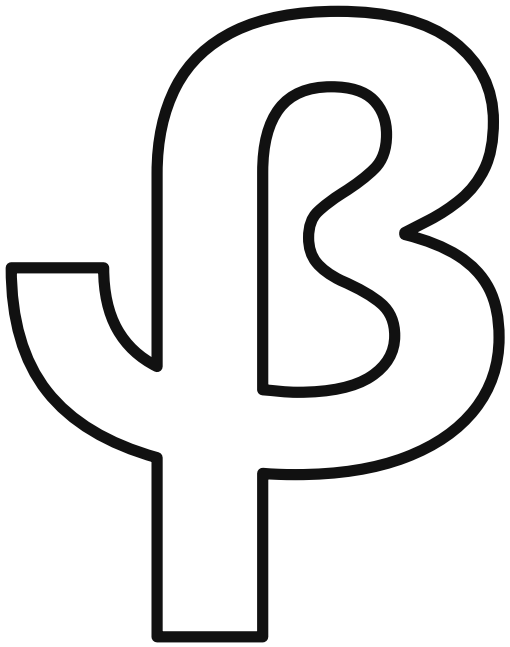
beans

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · AᏯᏫW

Ꮻ Ꮻ Ꮻ Ꮻ

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NAME · SVi

Ꮾ

ye

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

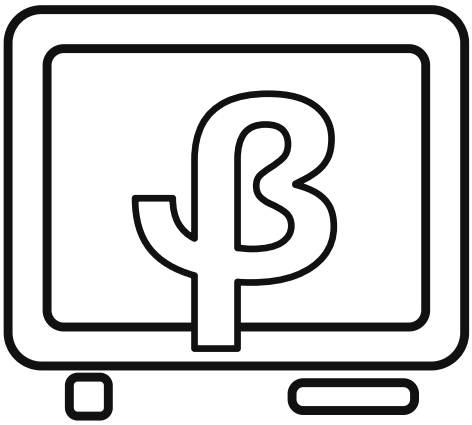
‘y’ as in “yes” + ‘eh’ as in “bed” → **yeh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭿ	Ꮾ	Ꮿ	Ᏸ	Ᏻ	Ᏼ
ya	ye	yi	yo	yu	yv

The box shows this sign in **the Y row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꮾ IS FOR

Ꮾ

yeh

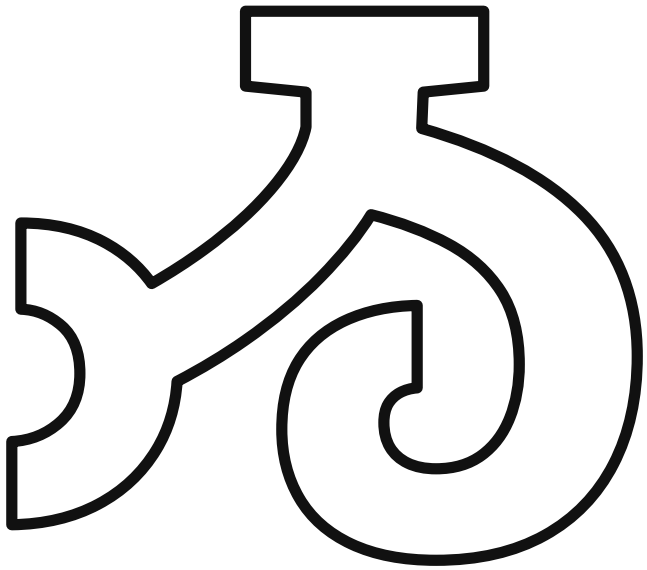
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

Ꮾ Ꮾ Ꮾ Ꮾ

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NAME · SVi

Ꮍ

yi

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

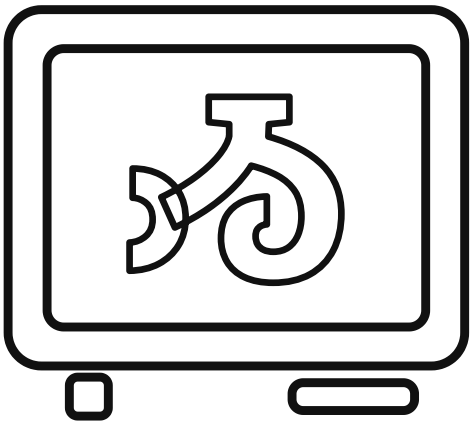
‘y’ as in “yes” + ‘ee’ as in “see” → **yee**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭿ	Ꮄ	Ꮍ	Ꮎ	Ꮏ	Ꮐ
ya	ye	yi	yo	yu	yv

The box shows this sign in **the Y row** of the syllabary chart.

Sound-practice page. We did not want to guess a Cherokee word for this sign, so there is none yet. Ask a Cherokee speaker for a word with this sound!



Ꮍ IS FOR

Ꮍ

yee

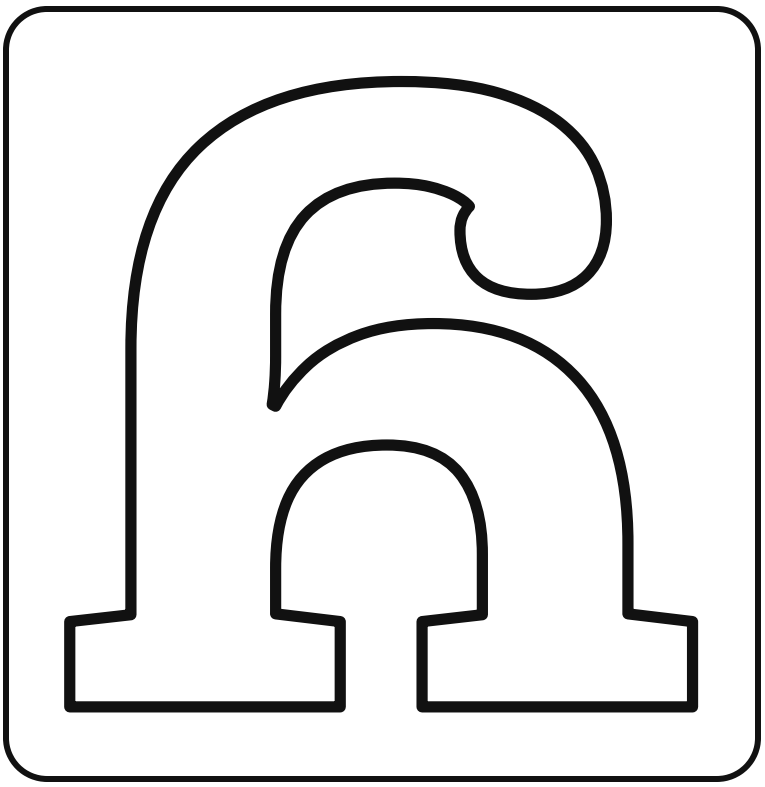
sound practice — say it three times

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏲᎳ

Ꮍ Ꮍ Ꮍ Ꮍ

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NAME · SVi

Ꮦ

yo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

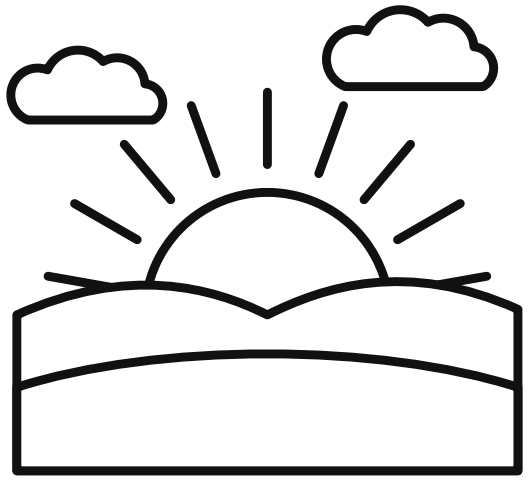
‘y’ as in “yes” + ‘oh’ as in “go” → **yoh**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

Ꭿ	Ꮆ	Ꮉ	**Ꮦ**	Ꮳ	Ᏼ
ya	ye	yi	**yo**	yu	yv

The box shows this sign in **the Y row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Ꮦ are rare, so find Ꮦ **inside** ᎣᏏᏲ (o-si-**yo**).



Ꮦ IS FOR

ᎣᏏᏲ

oh-see-yoh

hello!

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

Ꮦ Ꮦ Ꮦ Ꮦ

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Ꮆ

NAME · ᏚᏩi

Ꮆ

yu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

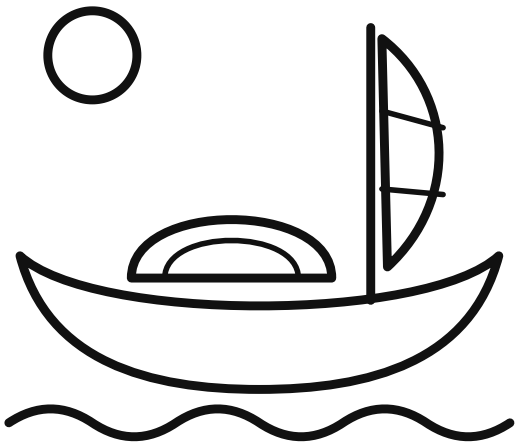
‘y’ as in “yes” + ‘oo’ as in “moon”
→ **yoo**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

ᏍᏆ	ᏋᏆ	ᏎᏆ	ᏐᏆ	**Ꮆ**	ᏆᏆ
ya	ye	yi	yo	yu	yv

The box shows this sign in **the Y row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with Ꮆ are rare, so find Ꮆ **inside** ᏥᏀ (tsi-**yu**).



Ꮆ IS FOR

ᏥᏀ

jee-yoo

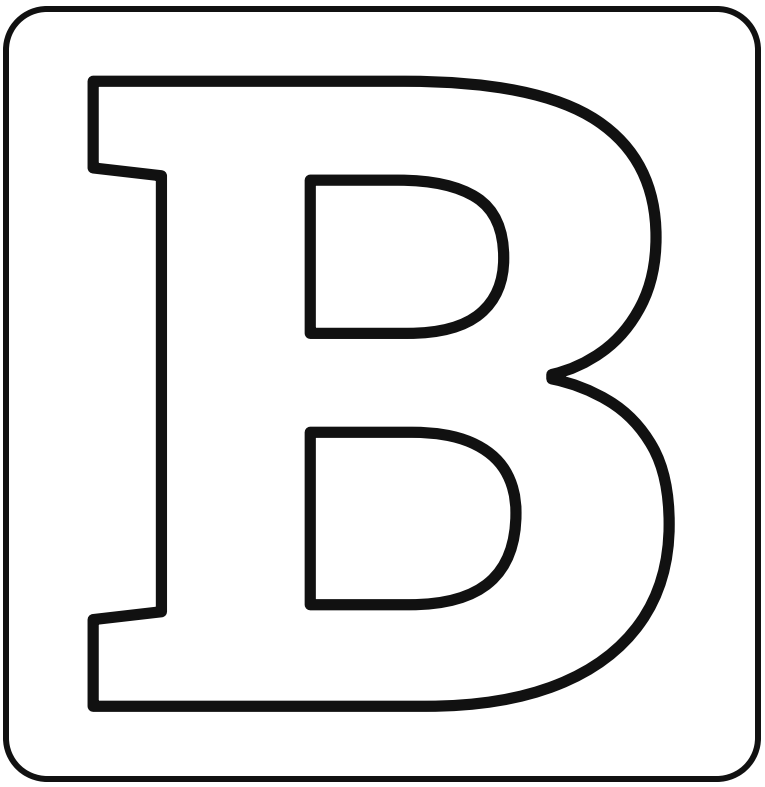
boat, canoe

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

Ꮆ Ꮆ Ꮆ Ꮆ

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NAME · ᏚᏩi

B

yv

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

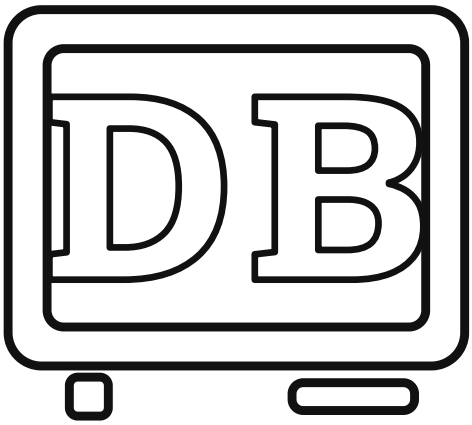
‘y’ as in “yes” + ‘uh’ said through the nose, like a humming “uh” → **yuhn**

ITS ROW IN THE SYLLABARY

ᏯᎧ	ᏰᎧ	ᏱᎧ	ᏲᎧ	ᏳᎧ	B
ya	ye	yi	yo	yu	yv

The box shows this sign in **the Y row** of the syllabary chart.

Words starting with B are rare, so find B **inside** DB (a-**yv**).



B IS FOR

DB

ah-yuhn

I, me

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᎠᏕᎳᏔ

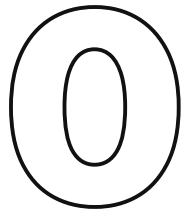
B B B B

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BONUS

Cherokee numbers ᏗᎪᏍᏗ *(dee-sehs-dee)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Cherokee: *tlah gohs-dee*, *sah-gwoo*, *tah-lee*, *joh-ee*...

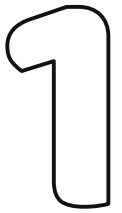


0

Ꮭ ᎪᏍᏗ

tlah gohs-dee

zero (“nothing”)



1

ᏐᏁ

sah-gwoo

one



2

ᏔᏢ

tah-lee

two

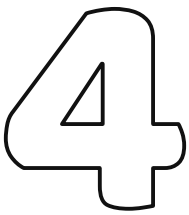


3

ᏦᎢ

joh-ee

three



4

ᏎᏉ

nuhn-gee

four



5

ᏱᏍᎩ

hees-gee

five



6

ᏣᏓᏢ

soo-dah-lee

six

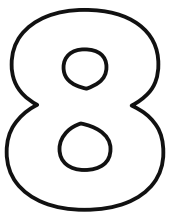


7

ᎦᏢᏉᎩ

gah-lee-gwoh-gee

seven



8

ᎫᏁᎳ

joo-neh-lah

eight



9

ᏐᏁᎳ

soh-neh-lah

nine

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LET'S TALK

My first Cherokee words ꭰᏏᏲ!

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

ᎠᏍᏆᎳᏯ
ᎠᎴᎫᏯ

as-sah-LAH-moo ah-LAY-koom
Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting, written in Cherokee signs)

ᏩᎠᎴᎫᏯ ᎠᏍᏆᎳᏯ

wah ah-LAY-koom as-sah-LAHM
And upon you be peace (the reply)

ꭰᏏᏲ!

oh-see-yoh
Hello!

ᏓᏆᏙi …

dah-gwah-doh-uhn …
My name is …

ᏩᏙ

wah-doh
Thank you

ᏣᎻᏕᎳᏁ ᏕᎢᎳᎾ

jah-zah-KAH-lah-hoo KHAI-rahn
Jazakallahu khairan — May Allah reward you with good

ᎡᏂ · ᎡᏙᏓ

eh-jee · eh-doh-dah
Mother · Father

ᎠᎩᎤᏟ · ᎠᎩᏙ

ah-gee-nuhn-tlee · ah-gee-doh
My brother · My sister (said by a boy)

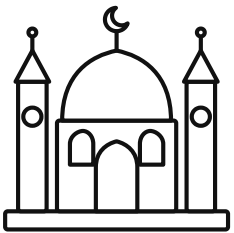
---

ii · iᏝ

uhn-uhn · uhn-tlah
Yes · No

ᏣᎳᎩ ᎠᏕᏩᏆᏍᎬ!

jah-lah-gee ah-deh-loh-gwahs-guhn
I am learning Cherokee!







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

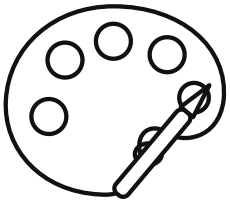
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International) and the **Cherokee Nation** Language Department; history of the syllabary from the **Cherokee Nation**.

What's next?
You have met all **85 Cherokee letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Cherokee, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

ᏕᎲᎳ! ᏰᏍᏆ!

MAH-shah-lah! ohs-dah! — Mashallah! Good — well done!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 85 letters of the Cherokee alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author



Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
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مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

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